

Representations of reductive groups over finite fields

By P. DELIGNE and G. LUSZTIG

Introduction

Let us consider a connected, reductive algebraic group G , defined over a finite field $\mathbb{F}_q$, with Frobenius map F . We shall be concerned with the representation theory of the finite group G^F , over fields of characteristic 0.

In 1968, Macdonald conjectured, on the basis of the character tables known at the time (GL_n, Sp_4), that there should be a well defined correspondence which, to any F -stable maximal torus T of G and a character θ of T^F in general position, associates an irreducible representation of G^F ; moreover, if T modulo the centre of G is anisotropic over $\mathbb{F}_q$, the corresponding representation of G^F should be cuspidal (see Seminar on algebraic groups and related finite groups, by A. Borel et al., Lecture Notes in Mathematics, 131, pp. 117 and 101). In this paper we prove Macdonald's conjecture. More precisely, for T as above and θ an arbitrary character of T^F we construct virtual representations R_T^θ which have all the required properties.

These are defined in Chapter 1 as the alternating sum of the cohomology with compact support of the variety of Borel subgroups of G which are in a fixed relative position with their F -transform, with coefficients in certain G^F -equivariant locally constant l -adic sheaves of rank one. This generalizes a construction made by Drinfeld for SL_2 (see Ch. 2).

In Chapter 4 we prove a character formula for R_T^θ , based on the fixed point formula of Chapter 3. This character formula is in terms of certain "Green functions" on the unipotent elements; in Chapters 6, 7, 8 we prove that these Green functions satisfy all the axioms predicted by Springer, Kilmoyer and Macdonald ([9], [12]).

By 6.8, $\pm R_T^\theta$ is irreducible if θ is in general position and the vanishing theorem (9.9) gives an explicit model for it provided that q is not too small (if G is a classical group or G_2 any q will do; in the general case $q \geq 30$ is sufficient).

In Chapter 10 we study the irreducible components of the Gelfand-Graev representation of G^F , assuming that the centre of G is connected. The proof uses the results of Chapter 5 together with the disjointness theorem (6.2).

Finally, in Chapter 11 we discuss the case of the Suzuki and Ree groups.

It would be very desirable to find formulas for the Green functions more explicit than (4.1.2). Such formulas are known for GL_n (Green [4]), Sp_4 (Srinivasan [13]) and G_2 (Chang, Ree [2]). Very recently, Kazhdan has proved, using results of Springer, that the Green functions can be expressed as exponential sums on the Lie algebra (see [12]) provided that the characteristic is good and q is not too small.

Some of the results in this paper were announced in [7], [8].

The second author would like to thank the I.H.E.S. for its hospitality during part of the time of preparation of this paper.

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Conventions and standard notations

0.1. In this paper, k is always an algebraically closed field and p is its characteristic exponent. The following assumptions and definitions will be in force in Chapters 4 to 8, in Chapter 10, and in parts of Chapters 1 and 9.

(0.1.1) p is a prime, and k is an algebraic closure of the prime field $\mathbb{F}_p$ of characteristic p . For q a power of p , $\mathbb{F}_q$ is the subfield with q elements of k . G is a reductive algebraic group over k , obtained by extension of scalars from G_0 over $\mathbb{F}_q$. We denote by F the corresponding Frobenius endomorphism $F : G \rightarrow G$ (as well as the Frobenius endomorphism of any k -scheme defined over $\mathbb{F}_q$).

0.2. l is a prime different from p , and $\overline{\mathbb{Q}_l}$ is an algebraic closure of the l -adic field. When there is no ambiguity on l , we will write simply $H_c^i(X)$ (resp. $H^i(X)$) for $H_c^i(X, \overline{\mathbb{Q}_l})$ (resp. $H^i(X, \overline{\mathbb{Q}_l})$) (l -adic cohomology of X , a scheme over k). The groups $\mathbb{Z}/l^n(1)$ are the groups $\mu_{l^n}(k)$ of l^n -roots of unity in k ; they form a projective system, with transition maps $x \mapsto x^{l^{n-m}}$; the projective limit is $\mathbb{Z}_l(1)$. One defines $\mathbb{Z}_l(n) = \mathbb{Z}_l(1)^{\otimes n}$, and $\mathbb{Z}_l(-n)$ the dual of $\mathbb{Z}_l(n)$. The symbol (n) is for a Tate twist: tensoring with $\mathbb{Z}_l(n)$. We will

make an accidental use of the similarly defined group $\widehat{\mathbb{Z}}_{p'}(1) = \varprojlim_{(n,p)=1} \mu_n(k)$.

0.3. For H a finite group, $\mathcal{R}(H)$ is the Grothendieck group of the finite dimensional representations of H over $\overline{\mathbb{Q}}_l$. If f and f' are class functions on H , with values in a cyclotomic field (often $\subset \overline{\mathbb{Q}}_l$), the inner product $\langle f, f' \rangle_H$ (or simply $\langle f, f' \rangle$) is

$$\frac{1}{|H|} \sum_{x \in H} f(x) \overline{f'(x)},$$

where the bar is the automorphism inducing $\zeta \mapsto \zeta^{-1}$ on the roots of unity. The same notation $\langle , \rangle$ will be used for the inner product of elements of $\mathcal{R}(H) \otimes \mathbb{Q}$, identified with their characters.

0.4. The length function on a Coxeter group W (with canonical generators $s_1, \dots, s_n$) will be denoted by $l(\cdot)$. A reduced expression for $w \in W$ is a decomposition $w = s_{i_1} \cdots s_{i_k}$ with $l(w) = k$.

0.5. Miscellaneous:

pr_i : i th projection (as in $\text{pr}_1 : X \times X \rightarrow X$);

X^T : the fixed point subscheme of the endomorphism T of the scheme X (for instance: $G^F = G_0(\mathbb{F}_q)$);

p' (in index): away from p (as in $\widehat{\mathbb{Z}}_{p'}$, completion away from p) or the subgroup of elements of order prime to p (as in $(\mathbb{Q}/\mathbb{Z})_{p'}$);

$\text{ad } g$: the inner automorphism $x \mapsto gxg^{-1}$, or maps deduced from it;

1 , or e : the identity element of a group;

$\text{Tr}(f, V^*)$, for f an endomorphism of a graded vector space, is

$$\sum (-1)^i \text{Tr}(f, V^i);$$

reductive: reductive groups are meant to be connected and smooth.

The Jordan decomposition of an element $g \in G$ (G as in (0.1.1)) is $g = su$ where s is a semisimple element and u is a unipotent element commuting with s .

0.6. We will often identify a scheme over k with the set of its k -rational points. This should cause no confusion.

1. Some basic definitions

1.1. Suppose that in some category we are given a family $(X_i)_{i \in I}$ of objects and a compatible system of isomorphisms $\varphi_{ji} : X_i \xrightarrow{\sim} X_j$. This is as good as giving a single object X , the “common value” or “projective limit” of the family. This projective limit is provided with isomorphisms $\sigma_i : X \xrightarrow{\sim} X_i$ such that $\varphi_{ji}\sigma_i = \sigma_j$. We will use such a construction to define the maximal torus T and the Weyl group W of a connected reductive algebraic group G over k .

As index set I , we take the set of pairs (T, B) consisting of a maximal torus T and a Borel subgroup B containing T . For $i \in I$, $i = (T, B)$, we take

$$T_i = T, \quad W_i = N(T)/T.$$

The isomorphism φ_{ji} is the isomorphism induced by $\text{ad } g$ where g is any element of G conjugating i into j ; these elements g form a single right T_i -coset, so that φ_{ji} is independent of the choice of g .

One similarly defines the root system of T , its set of simple roots, the action of W on T and the fundamental reflections in W .

Let $F : G \rightarrow G$ be an isogeny. For any $i \in I$, $i = (T, B)$, $F(i) = (F(T), F(B))$ is again in I ; F induces an isogeny $F : T_i \rightarrow T_{F(i)}$ and an isomorphism $F : W_i \rightarrow W_{F(i)}$. The corresponding endomorphism (resp. automorphism) $\sigma_{F(i)}^{-1} F \sigma_i$ of the torus T (resp. of the Weyl groups W) is independent of the choice of i ; we say that it is induced by F .

1.2. Let X (or X_G) be the set of all Borel subgroups of G . The group G acts on X by conjugation, and X is a smooth projective homogeneous space of G . For each Borel subgroup B of G , B is the stabilizer of the corresponding point of X , hence there is a natural isomorphism $G/B \rightarrow X : g \mapsto gBg^{-1}$.

The set of orbits of G in $X \times X$ can be identified with the Weyl group W of G as follows: for any $i = (T, B)$ as in (1.1), use the composite bijection

$$W \xrightarrow{\sigma_i} N(T)/T \xrightarrow{\sim} B \backslash G/B \xrightarrow[\langle e, g \rangle]{\sim} G \backslash (G/B \times G/B) \xrightarrow{\sim} G \backslash (X \times X);$$

this is independent of the choice of (T, B) . We denote by $O(w)$ the orbit corresponding to $w \in W$; this is the orbit of $(B, \dot{w}B\dot{w}^{-1})$, where $\dot{w} \in N(T)$ represents w . We shall say that two Borel subgroups B', B'' of G are in relative position w , $w \in W$, if and only if $(B', B'') \in O(w)$. In diagrams, we will picture this by

$$B' \xrightarrow{w} B''.$$

The basic properties of Bruhat decomposition can be expressed as follows:

(a) If $w = w_1 w_2$, with $l(w) = l(w_1) + l(w_2)$ then

(a₁) $(B', B'') \in O(w_1)$ and $(B'', B''') \in O(w_2) \Rightarrow (B', B''') \in O(w)$;

(a₂) if $(B', B''') \in O(w)$, there is one and only one B'' such that $(B', B'') \in O(w_1)$ and $(B'', B''') \in O(w_2)$.

On the scheme level:

$$O(w_1) \times_X O(w_2) \xrightarrow{\sim} O(w).$$

(b) Let s be an elementary reflection and let B be a Borel subgroup.

(b₁) $P = B \cup BsB$ is a (minimal parabolic) subgroup, i.e., if $(B', B'') \in O(s)$ and $(B'', B''') \in O(s)$, then either $(B', B''') \in O(s)$ or $B' = B'''$.

(b₂) The quotient $\bar{L}$ of $L = P/U_P$ (U_P = unipotent radical of P) by its centre is isomorphic to $PGL(2)$. The space $X_{\bar{L}}$ is hence a projective line. The inverse image map $X_{\bar{L}} \rightarrow X$ has as image the set of Borel subgroups B' in relative position e or s with B .

(b₃) Via either projection, $\overline{O(s)} = O(s) \cup O(e) \subset X \times X$ is hence a fibre

space over X , with fibre P_1 . It is provided with the section $O(e)$; this reduces its structural group from the projective to the affine group. The complement $O(s)$ of that section is a fibre space with fibre the affine line.

1.3. The assumptions (0.1.1) are in force in the rest of this chapter. The scheme X is hence defined over $\mathbb{F}_q$ and provided with a Frobenius map $F : X \rightarrow X$.

DEFINITION 1.4. For w in the Weyl group $\mathbf{W}$ of G , $X(w) \subset X$ is the locally closed subscheme of X consisting of all Borel subgroups B of G such that B and $F(B)$ are in relative position w .

One can also regard $X(w)$ as the intersection, in $X \times X$, of $O(w)$ with the graph of Frobenius. It is easily checked that this intersection is transverse. The orbit $O(w)$ being smooth of dimension $\dim(X) + l(w)$, it follows that $X(w)$ is smooth and purely of dimension $l(w)$. The subscheme $X(w)$ of X is G^F -stable. Hence, for each prime number $l \neq p$, G^F acts on the l -adic cohomology with compact supports of $X(w)$.

DEFINITION 1.5. $R^1(w)$ is the virtual representation

$$\sum (-1)^i H_c^i(X(w), \overline{\mathbb{Q}}_l)$$

of G^F (an element of the Grothendieck group of representations of G^F over $\overline{\mathbb{Q}}_l$).

For $w = e$, $X(w)$ is of dimension 0; it is the set of rational Borel subgroups, and $R^1(w)$ is induced by the unit representation of B^F , where B is an F -stable Borel subgroup.

It will follow from (3.3) that the character of $R^1(w)$ has integral values, independent of l . This will justify omitting l from the notation; $R^1(w)$ could be also regarded as a complex virtual representation of G^F .

An element of the Weyl group $\mathbf{W}$ is said to be F -conjugate to $w \in \mathbf{W}$, if it is of the form $w_1 w F(w_1)^{-1}$, for some $w_1 \in \mathbf{W}$. We denote by W_F^- the set of F -conjugacy classes in $\mathbf{W}$. We shall recall in (1.14), that the G^F -conjugacy classes of F -stable (i.e., $\mathbb{F}_q$ -rational) maximal tori in G are parametrized by W_F^- .

THEOREM 1.6. $R^1(w)$ depends only on the F -conjugacy class of w .

Let w and w' be F -conjugate.

Case 1. $w = w_1 w_2$, $w' = w_2 F(w_1)$ and $l(w) = l(w_1) + l(w_2) = l(w_2) + l(F(w_1)) = l(w')$ (0.4). For $B \in X(w)$, there is a unique Borel subgroup σB such that $(B, \sigma B) \in O(w_1)$ and $(\sigma B, FB) \in O(w_2)$; we have the diagram of relative positions:

$$\begin{array}{ccc}
B & \xrightarrow{w_1 w_2} & F(B) \\
w_1 \downarrow & \nearrow w_2 & \downarrow F(w_1) \\
\sigma B & \xrightarrow{w_2 F(w_1)} & F(\sigma B)
\end{array}$$

(the bottom one because $l(w_2 F(w_1)) = l(w_2) + l(F(w_1))$, and $\sigma B \in X(w')$). By the same argument applied to $w_2 F(w_1)$ and $F(w_1)F(w_2) = F(w)$, we get a map $\tau : X(w') \rightarrow X(Fw)$. The diagram

$$\begin{array}{ccc}
X(w) & \xrightarrow{\sigma} & X(w') \\
F \downarrow & \swarrow \tau & \downarrow F \\
X(Fw) & \xrightarrow{\sigma^{(q)}} & X(Fw')
\end{array}$$

is commutative. The vertical maps induce equivalences of étale sites, hence so do τ and σ [SGA 1, IX, 4.10]. The resulting isomorphism

$$H_c^*(X(w')) \xrightarrow{\sim} H_c^*(X(w))$$

is G^F -equivariant, whence (1.6) in this case.

Case 2. For some fundamental reflection s , we have $w' = swF(s)$ and $l(w') = l(w) + 2$. For $B \in X(w')$, we can find two Borel subgroups $\gamma B, \delta B$ such that $(B, \gamma B) \in O(s)$, $(\gamma B, \delta B) \in O(w)$, $(\delta B, FB) \in O(F(s))$; moreover, γB and δB are uniquely determined by these requirements. We define a partition $X(w') = X_1 \cup X_2$ by

$$X_1 = \{B \in X(w') \mid \delta B = F(\gamma B)\}, \quad X_2 = \{B \in X(w') \mid \delta B \neq F(\gamma B)\}.$$

Note that X_1 is a closed subscheme of $X(w')$, while X_2 is an open one. We have $\gamma : X_1 \rightarrow X(w)$ and, for $B' \in X(w)$, $\gamma^{-1}(B')$ is the set of all Borel subgroups B such that $(B, B') \in O(s)$; hence $\gamma^{-1}(B')$ is an affine line over k , and X_1 is (via γ) an affine line bundle over $X(w)$. It follows that γ induces an isomorphism

$$H_c^i(X_1) \xrightarrow{\sim} H_c^{i-2}(X(w))(-1), \quad i \geq 0. \quad (1.6.1)$$

If $B \in X_2$, we have

$$(\delta B, FB) \in O(F(s)), \quad (FB, F(\gamma B)) \in O(F(s)), \quad \delta B \neq F(\gamma B),$$

hence $(\delta B, F(\gamma B)) \in O(F(s))$. Since

$$(F(\gamma B), F(\delta B)) \in O(F(w)), \quad l(F(sw)) = l(F(s)) + l(F(w)),$$

it follows that $(\delta B, F(\delta B)) \in O(F(sw))$. Thus we have $\delta : X_2 \rightarrow X(F(sw))$. Let

$$X'_2 = \{(B, \tilde{B}) \in X_2 \times X(sw) \mid F(\tilde{B}) = \delta B\}$$

and let $\delta' : X'_2 \rightarrow X(sw)$ be defined by $\delta'(B, \tilde{B}) = \tilde{B}$; we define also $\varphi : X'_2 \rightarrow X_2$ by $\varphi(B, \tilde{B}) = B$. We have a cartesian

diagram

$$\begin{array}{ccc} X'_2 & \xrightarrow{\delta'} & X(sw) \\ \varphi \downarrow & & \downarrow F \\ X_2 & \xrightarrow{\delta} & X(F(sw)). \end{array} \quad (1.6.2)$$

For any $\tilde{B} \in X(sw)$ we denote by $s\tilde{B}$ the unique Borel subgroup such that $(\tilde{B}, s\tilde{B}) \in O(s)$, $(s\tilde{B}, F\tilde{B}) \in O(w)$. It is easy to see that $\delta'^{-1}(\tilde{B})$ can be identified with the set of Borel subgroups B such that $(\tilde{B}, B) \in O(s)$, $B \neq s\tilde{B}$; it follows that $\delta'^{-1}(\tilde{B})$ is an affine line with a point removed. Thus X'_2 is (via δ') a line bundle over $X(sw)$ with the zero-section removed. Since the vertical arrows in (1.6.2) induce equivalences of étale sites, we have a canonical exact sequence (see [5]):

$$\cdots \xrightarrow{\partial} H_c^{i-1}(X(sw)) \longrightarrow H_c^i(X_2) \longrightarrow H_c^{i-2}(X(sw))(-1) \xrightarrow{\partial} H_c^i(X(sw)) \longrightarrow \cdots. \quad (1.6.3)$$

It can be proved that the maps ∂ in (1.6.3) are zero; this fact will not be used here.

Note that (1.6.1) and (1.6.3) are G^F -equivariant and that G^F acts trivially on $\overline{\mathbb{Q}}_l(-1)$. It follows that for any $g \in G^F$:

$$\begin{aligned} \mathrm{tr}(g^*, H_c^*(X_2)) &= 0, \\ \mathrm{tr}(g^*, H_c^*(X_1)) &= \mathrm{tr}(g^*, H_c^*(X(w))). \end{aligned}$$

If one uses the exact sequence

$$\cdots \longrightarrow H_c^{i-1}(X_1) \longrightarrow H_c^i(X_2) \longrightarrow H_c^i(X(w')) \longrightarrow H_c^i(X_1) \longrightarrow \cdots,$$

it follows that

$$\begin{aligned} \mathrm{tr}(g^*, H_c^*(X(w'))) &= \mathrm{tr}(g^*, H_c^*(X_1)) + \mathrm{tr}(g^*, H_c^*(X_2)) \\ &= \mathrm{tr}(g^*, H_c^*(X(w))) \end{aligned}$$

and 1.6 is proved in this case.

The general case. It suffices to treat the case where $w' = swF(s)$ for a fundamental reflection s . By permuting, if necessary, w and w' ($w = sw'F(s)$), we may even assume that $l(w') \geq l(w)$. If $l(w') > l(w)$ we are in case 2. If $l(w') = l(w)$, the following lemma shows that either we are in case 1 (with w and w' possibly interchanged) or that $w = w'$.

LEMMA 1.6.4. Let s, t be two fundamental reflections in W and let $w \in W$ be such that $l(w) = l(sw)$. Then either $w = swt$, or

$$l(sw) = l(w) - 1, \quad \text{or} \quad l(wt) = l(w) - 1.$$

Let $w = s_1 s_2 \cdots s_k$ be a reduced expression for w (0.4). Assume that $l(wt) = l(w) + 1$; then $wt = s_1 s_2 \cdots s_k t$ is also a reduced expression. We have $l(swt) = l(wt) - 1$. It follows (cf. Bourbaki, [1, Ch. IV, §1, Lemme 3]) that either there exists j , $1 \leq j \leq k$, with

$$ss_1 \cdots s_{j-1} = s_1 \cdots s_{j-1} s_j,$$

or we have

$$ss_1 \cdots s_k = s_1 \cdots s_k t.$$

In the first case, we have $w = ss_1 \cdots s_{j-1} s_{j+1} \cdots s_k$ and $l(sw) = l(w) - 1$; in the second case we have $w = swt$ and the lemma is proved.

1.7. Let us choose a maximal torus T^* in G and a Borel subgroup $B^* \subset G$ containing T^* , with unipotent radical U^* . The quotient $E = G/U^*$ is a T^* -torsor (= right principal homogeneous space of T^*) over $X = G/B^*$. For $x \in X$, the fibre $E(x)$ of the projection $E \rightarrow X$ is

$$E(x) = \{g \in G \mid ge^* = x\}/U^*,$$

where e^* is the point of X corresponding to B^* .

Let $\dot{w} \in N(T^*)$ define the element w in the Weyl group $\mathbf{W}$ via the isomorphism $\sigma(T^*, B^*) : \mathbf{W} \xrightarrow{\sim} N(T^*)/T^*$. If $x, y \in X$ are in relative position w , the g 's in G such that $ge^* = x$ and $g\dot{w}e^* = y$ form a torsor $A(x, y)$ under

$$B^* \cap \dot{w}B^*\dot{w}^{-1} = T^* \cdot (U^* \cap \dot{w}U^*\dot{w}^{-1}).$$

For $g \in A(x, y)$, the class of $g\dot{w}$ in $E(y)$ depends only on the class of g in $E(x)$. This defines a map $E(x) \rightarrow E(y)$, which we denote as right multiplication by $\dot{w}$. We have the formulas

$$(ut)\dot{w} = (u\dot{w})\text{ad } \dot{w}^{-1}(t), \quad (1.7.1)$$

$$u(\dot{w}t) = (u\dot{w})t. \quad (1.7.2)$$

We will express (1.7.1) by saying that $\cdot\dot{w}$ is a w -map of T^* -torsors. It is induced by a w -map of T^* -torsors over $O(w)$

$$\cdot\dot{w} : \text{pr}_1^* E \longrightarrow \text{pr}_2^* E.$$

Assume that $w = w_1 w_2$, $\dot{w} = \dot{w}_1 \dot{w}_2$ and that $l(w) = l(w_1) + l(w_2)$; then for $x, y, z \in X$ with $(x, y) \in O(w_1)$ and $(y, z) \in O(w_2)$, we have $(x, z) \in O(w)$ and

$$u\dot{w} = (u\dot{w}_1)\dot{w}_2. \quad (1.7.3)$$

1.8. We now assume that T^* and B^* are F -stable. The identification $\sigma(T^*, B^*)$ of T^* and $N(T^*)/T^*$ with the torus $\mathbf{T}$ and the Weyl group $\mathbf{W}$ is then compatible with F . For w in the Weyl group, we denote by $\mathbf{T}(w)$ the torus $\mathbf{T}$, provided with the rational structure for which the Frobenius is $\text{ad}(\dot{w})F$. We have

$$\mathbf{T}(w)^F \simeq \{t \in T^* \mid \text{ad}(\dot{w})F(t) = t\}.$$

For $x \in X$, the Frobenius map induces a map $F : E(x) \rightarrow E(F(x))$, with $F(ut) = F(u)F(t)$. For $x \in X(w)$, we put

$$E(x, \dot{w}) = \{u \in E(x) \mid F(u) = u\dot{w}\}.$$

This is a $T(w)^F$ -torsor. The $E(x, \dot{w})$ are the fibres of a map

$$\pi : \tilde{X}(\dot{w}) \longrightarrow X(w),$$

with $\tilde{X}(\dot{w}) \subset E \mid X(w)$ a $T(w)^F$ -torsor over $X(w)$. The action of G on E restricts to an action of G^F on $\tilde{X}(\dot{w})$.

Up to isomorphism, the G^F -equivariant $T(w)^F$ -torsor $\tilde{X}(\dot{w})$ over $X(w)$ is independent of the lifting $\dot{w}$ of w in $N(T^*)$: for $\dot{w}' = \dot{w}t$, there exists t_1 with $\text{ad } \dot{w}^{-1}(t_1)F(t_1)^{-1} = t$ and the map $u \mapsto ut_1$ induces an isomorphism

$$\tilde{X}(\dot{w}) \xrightarrow{\sim} \tilde{X}(\dot{w}').$$

The groups G^F and $T(w)^F$ act on $H_c^*(\tilde{X}(\dot{w}), \overline{\mathbb{Q}}_l)$ by transport of structure. For any $\theta \in \text{Hom}(T(w)^F, \overline{\mathbb{Q}}_l^*)$ we denote by $H_c^*(\tilde{X}(\dot{w}), \overline{\mathbb{Q}}_l)_\theta$ the subspace of $H_c^*(\tilde{X}(\dot{w}), \overline{\mathbb{Q}}_l)$ on which $T(w)^F$ acts by θ .

DEFINITION 1.9. $R^\theta(w)$ is the virtual representation

$$\sum (-1)^i H_c^i(\tilde{X}(\dot{w}), \overline{\mathbb{Q}}_l)_\theta$$

of G^F (an element of the Grothendieck group of representations of G^F over $\overline{\mathbb{Q}}_l$).

The character θ can be used to transform the $T(w)^F$ -torsor $\tilde{X}(\dot{w})$ into a local system of $\overline{\mathbb{Q}}_l$ -vector spaces of rank one $\mathcal{F}_\theta$ over $X(w)$, provided with

$$\theta : \tilde{X}(\dot{w}) \longrightarrow \mathcal{F}_\theta, \quad \theta(xt) = \theta(x)\theta(t).$$

The morphism $\pi : \tilde{X}(\dot{w}) \rightarrow X(w)$ is finite and

$$\pi_* \overline{\mathbb{Q}}_l = \bigoplus_{\theta} \mathcal{F}_\theta.$$

The sheaf $\mathcal{F}_\theta$ is the subsheaf of $\pi_* \overline{\mathbb{Q}}_l$ on which T^F acts by θ , hence

$$H_c^*(\tilde{X}(\dot{w}), \overline{\mathbb{Q}}_l)_\theta = H_c^*(X(w), \mathcal{F}_\theta).$$

In particular, for $\theta = 1$,

$$R^1(w) = \sum (-1)^i H_c^i(X(w), \overline{\mathbb{Q}}_l)$$

so that Definition 1.9 is compatible with (1.5).

Example 1.10. For $w = \dot{w} = e$, $\pi : \tilde{X}(\dot{w}) \rightarrow X(w)$ becomes the projection

$$\pi : G^F/U^{*F} \longrightarrow G^F/B^{*F},$$

and $R^\theta(w)$ is the representation of G^F on the space of functions on G^F satisfying

$$f(gtu) = \theta(t)^{-1} f(g),$$

G^F acting by $(g * f)(x) = f(g^{-1}x)$ (induced representation).

1.11. The Borel subgroup $\text{ad } gB^*$ is in $X(w)$ if and only if $\text{ad } gB^*$ and $\text{ad } FgB^*$ are in relative position w , i.e., if and only if $g^{-1}Fg \in B^* \dot{w} B^*$ (where $\dot{w} \in N(T^*)$ represents w):

$$X(w) = \{g \in G \mid g^{-1}Fg \in B^* \dot{w} B^*\} / B^*. \quad (1.11.1)$$

If a Borel subgroup B is in $X(w)$, one can find $g \in G$ such that $\text{ad } gB^*$ is

B and $\text{ad } g \text{ ad } \dot{w}B^* = FB$:

$$X(w) = \{g \in G \mid g^{-1}Fg \in \dot{w}B^*\} / (B^* \cap \text{ad } \dot{w}B^*), \quad (1.11.2)$$

where

$$B^* \cap \text{ad } \dot{w}B^* = T^* \cdot (U^* \cap \text{ad } \dot{w}U^*).$$

Changing g to gt , we can normalize g so that we have also $g^{-1}Fg \in \dot{w}U^*$:

$$X(w) = \{g \in G \mid g^{-1}Fg \in \dot{w}U^*\} / (T(w)^F \cdot (U^* \cap \text{ad } \dot{w}U^*)). \quad (1.11.3)$$

A point in $\tilde{X}(\dot{w})$ is defined by a Borel subgroup B , plus $g \in G$ such that $\text{ad } gB^* = B$, $\text{ad } g \text{ ad } \dot{w}B^* = FB$ and $g\dot{w} = Fg \bmod U^*$:

$$\tilde{X}(\dot{w}) = \{g \in G \mid g^{-1}Fg \in \dot{w}U^*\} / (U^* \cap \text{ad } \dot{w}U^*). \quad (1.11.4)$$

COROLLARY 1.12. The following assertions are equivalent:

- (i) $X(w)$ is affine;
- (ii) $\tilde{X}(\dot{w})$ is affine;
- (iii) Let ρ be the action of $U^* \cap \text{ad } \dot{w}U^*$ on U^* defined by

$$\rho(u)v = \text{ad } \dot{w}^{-1}(u)vF(u^{-1});$$

then $U^* / \rho(U^* \cap \text{ad } \dot{w}U^*)$ is affine.

Put $S = \{g \in G \mid g^{-1}Fg \in \dot{w}U^*\}$. The map $f : S \rightarrow U^* : g \mapsto \dot{w}^{-1}g^{-1}Fg$ induces an isomorphism $G^F \backslash S \rightarrow U^*$ and is such that, for $u \in U^* \cap \text{ad } \dot{w}U^*$,

$$f(gu) = \rho(u)^{-1}f(g).$$

Hence,

$$G^F \backslash \tilde{X}(\dot{w}) \simeq U^* / (U^* \cap \text{ad } \dot{w}U^*).$$

As $\tilde{X}(\dot{w})/T(w)^F = X(w)$, it only remains to use the fact that a space and a quotient of it by a finite group are simultaneously affine or not.

We will have to use another description of $\pi : \tilde{X}(\dot{w}) \rightarrow X(w)$. First, an easy lemma:

LEMMA 1.13. Let J be the set of pairs (T, B) , T an F -stable maximal torus and B a Borel subgroup containing T . The map h which to (T, B) associates the relative position of B and FB induces a bijection

$$G^F \backslash J \xrightarrow{\sim} \mathbf{W}.$$

The proof will be given in (1.15).

If we use $(T, B) \in J$ to identify $\mathbf{W}$ with $N(T)/T$, we have

$$h(T, \text{ad } \dot{w}B) = \dot{w}^{-1}h(T, B)F(w), \quad (1.13.1)$$

where $\dot{w} \in N(T)$ represents w , hence

COROLLARY 1.14. The map h induces a bijection

$$\{G^F\text{-conjugacy classes of } F\text{-stable maximal tori}\} \xrightarrow{\sim} \mathbf{W}_{\tilde{F}}.$$

Here is another description of h : for $(T, B) \in J$, if $\sigma : T \rightarrow T$ and $\sigma : \mathbf{W} \rightarrow \mathbf{W}$

$(W = N(T)/T)$ are defined by (T, B) , then

$$\sigma F \sigma^{-1} = \text{ad } h(T, B) \circ F : T \longrightarrow T.$$

To give $h(T, B)$ is the same as to give $\text{ad } h(T, B) \circ F \in W \circ F \subset \text{End}(T)$, and to give the F -conjugacy class of $h(T, B)$ is the same as to give $\text{ad } h(T, B) \circ F$ up to W -conjugacy.

1.15. The space of maximal tori of G can be identified with the homogeneous space $G/N(T^*)$, and the space of maximal tori marked by a containing Borel subgroup can be identified with G/T^* . The group T^* being the connected component of $N(T^*)$, (1.13) is a special case of the general result described below.

Let G_0 be a connected algebraic group over $\mathbb{F}_q$ and let $x : \tilde{E}_0 \rightarrow E_0$ be a morphism of G_0 -homogeneous spaces. We denote by $G, \tilde{E}, E$ the corresponding objects over k , and we assume that the stabilizer $S(\tilde{e})$ of $\tilde{e} \in \tilde{E}$ is the connected component of the stabilizer $S(\pi(\tilde{e}))$ of $\pi(\tilde{e}) \in E$. Since any G_0 -homogeneous space has a rational point, the existence of $\tilde{E}_0$ imposes no condition on E_0 .

The groups $S(e)/S(e)^0$ form a local system on E , which becomes constant on $\tilde{E}$; we denote by W its constant value on $\tilde{E}$. For $\tilde{e} \in \tilde{E}$, we have an isomorphism

$$\alpha(\tilde{e}) : W \xrightarrow{\sim} S(\pi(\tilde{e}))/S(\pi(e)),$$

and, for $\tilde{f} = g\tilde{e}$, we have $\alpha(\tilde{f}) = \text{ad } g \alpha(\tilde{e})$. We let the group W act on $\tilde{E}$ on the right, by

$$\tilde{e} w = \alpha(\tilde{e})(w)\tilde{e};$$

in this way, $\tilde{E}$ becomes a W -torsor (= principal homogeneous space) over E .

The group W is acted on by F , with $F(\tilde{e} w) = F(\tilde{e})F(w)$. The set $W_{\tilde{F}}$ of F -conjugacy classes in W is the set of orbits of the action of W on itself by

$$w \longmapsto w_1 w F(w_1)^{-1}.$$

PROPOSITION 1.16. For $e \in E^F$ and $\tilde{e} \in E$ above it, define $h(e, \tilde{e}) \in W$ by

$$F(\tilde{e}) = \tilde{e} \cdot h(e, \tilde{e}).$$

(i) The map h induces a bijection from the set of G^F -orbits in

$$\{(e, \tilde{e}) \mid e \in E^F, \pi(\tilde{e}) = e\}$$

to W .

(ii) We have

$$h(e, \tilde{e} w) = w^{-1} h(e, \tilde{e}) F(w).$$

Hence the map h induces a bijection from $G^F \backslash E^F$ to the set of F -conjugacy classes in W .

We will only prove (i). Let Y be the set of $\tilde{e} \in E$ such that $\pi(\tilde{e}) \in E^F$. If $\tilde{e}_0 \in E^F$, the map $g \mapsto g\tilde{e}_0$ identifies X with

$$\{g \in G \mid g^{-1} F g \in S(\pi(\tilde{e}_0))\} / S(\tilde{e}_0).$$

The Lang isogeny $g \mapsto g^{-1} F g$ is an isomorphism $G^F \backslash G \rightarrow G$, hence the map $g e_0 \mapsto g^{-1} F g$ induces a bijection

$$G^F \backslash X \xrightarrow{\sim} S(\pi(\tilde{e}_0)) / (S(\tilde{e}_0) \text{ acting by } x \mapsto s^{-1} x F(s)).$$

The orbits of this action of $S(\tilde{e}_0)$ are just the usual cosets, and the resulting

bijection $G^F \backslash X \xrightarrow{\sim} W$ is the h above.

DEFINITION 1.17. Let T be an F -stable maximal torus and let B be a Borel subgroup containing T , with unipotent radical U ; let w be the relative position of B and FB .

(i) $X_{T \subset B}$ is $X(w)$. The map $g \mapsto \text{ad } gB$ induces isomorphisms

$$\begin{aligned} X_{T \subset B} &= \{g \in G \mid g^{-1}Fg \in B \cdot F(B)\}/B \\ &= \{g \in G \mid g^{-1}Fg \in FB\}/(B \cap FB) \\ &= \{g \in G \mid g^{-1}Fg \in FU\}/(T^F \cdot (U \cap FU)). \end{aligned}$$

(ii) $\tilde{X}_{T \subset B}$ is

$$\{g \in G \mid g^{-1}Fg \in FU\}/(U \cap FU).$$

We have a projection map $\pi : \tilde{X}_{T \subset B} \rightarrow X_{T \subset B}$, for which $\tilde{X}_{T \subset B}$ is a G^F -equivariant T^F -torsor over $X_{T \subset B}$; G^F acts by left multiplication and T^F by right multiplication (it normalizes $U \cap FU$).

1.18. Let $\dot{w} \in N(T^*)$ be a representative of w . If $x' \in G$ is such that $\text{ad } x'(T^*, B^*) = (T, B)$ then B and $FB = \text{ad } Fx' B^*$ are in relative position w , and FB contains T , hence $FB = \text{ad } x' \text{ ad } \dot{w} B^*$ and

$$x'^{-1}F(x') \in \dot{w} B^* \cap N(T^*) = \dot{w} T^*.$$

Replacing x' by $x = x't$ ($t \in T^*$) one can achieve $x^{-1}F(x) = \dot{w}$. The x such that $\text{ad } x(T^*, B^*) = (T, B)$ and $x^{-1}F(x) = \dot{w}$ form a T^{*F} -torsor. For such an x , $\text{ad } x$ induces an isomorphism $T(w) \rightarrow T$ (hence $T(w)^F \rightarrow T^F$); this isomorphism is independent of x .

PROPOSITION 1.19. Let T, B, U, w be as in (1.17) and $x, \dot{w}$ as in (1.18). The map $g \mapsto gx^{-1}$ induces an isomorphism from the G^F -equivariant $T(w)^F$ -torsor $\tilde{X}(\dot{w})$ over $X(w)$ (or rather its model (1.11)) to the G^F -equivariant T^F -torsor $\tilde{X}_{T \subset B}$ over $X_{T \subset B}$ (or rather its model (1.17)).

This is a straightforward computation.

1.20. The cohomology of $\tilde{X}_{T \subset B}$ is acted on by G^F and T^F . For any character $\theta : T^F \rightarrow \overline{\mathbb{Q}}_l^*$ we put as in (1.8):

$$R_{T \subset B}^\theta = \sum_i (-1)^i H_c^i(\tilde{X}_{T \subset B}, \overline{\mathbb{Q}}_l)_\theta$$

(an element in the Grothendieck group of representations of G^F over $\overline{\mathbb{Q}}_l$).

By (1.19), for x as in (1.18), we have

$$R_{T \subset B}^\theta = R^{\theta \circ \text{ad } x}(\dot{w}).$$

We shall see in Chapter 4 that $R_{T \subset B}^\theta$ is independent of B . For $g \in G^F$ such that $\text{ad } g$ carries T, B, θ to T', B', θ' , we have clearly

$$R_{T \subset B}^\theta = R_{T' \subset B'}^{\theta'},$$

hence $R_{T \subset B}^\theta$ will eventually depend only on the G^F -conjugacy class of T and on the orbit of θ under $(N(T)/T)^F$.

The end of this chapter will be used in the proof of 7.10 only.

1.21. Isogenies. Let T be an F -stable maximal torus of G , and let Z be the centre of G . We denote $G \times^Z T$ the quotient of $G \times T$ by the subgroup

$$\{(z, z^{-1}) \mid z \in Z\}.$$

Let B be a Borel subgroup containing T . The action $x \mapsto gxt$ of $G^F \times T^F$ on $\tilde{X}_{TCB}$ is induced by an action of $(G \times^Z T)^F$, given by the same formula.

COROLLARY 1.22. On $H^*(\tilde{X}_{TCB}, \overline{\mathbb{Q}}_l)_\theta$, Z^F acts by the character $\theta \mid Z^F$. In particular, on any irreducible representation occurring in R_{TCB}^θ , Z^F acts by $\theta \mid Z^F$.

Let $\pi : \tilde{G} \rightarrow G$ be the simply connected covering of the derived group of G , $\tilde{T} = \pi^{-1}(T)$, $\tilde{B} = \pi^{-1}(B)$ and let $\tilde{Z}$ be the centre of $\tilde{G}$.

PROPOSITION 1.23. One has

$$T^F / \pi(\tilde{T}^F) \xrightarrow{\sim} G^F / \pi(\tilde{G}^F).$$

Injectivity is clear; we have to check the surjectivity of the map

$$(T \times \tilde{G})^F \longrightarrow G^F$$

induced by

$$\varphi : T \times \tilde{G} \longrightarrow G : \quad t, \tilde{g} \longmapsto t\pi(\tilde{g}).$$

Via φ , $T \times \tilde{G}$ is a $\tilde{T}$ -torsor over G (with

$$(t, \tilde{g}) * \tilde{t} = (t\tilde{t}, \tilde{t}^{-1}\tilde{g})),$$

and one applies Lang's theorem to the connected group $\tilde{T}$.

1.24. Let $h : A \rightarrow B$ be a homomorphism of finite groups and let X be a space on which A acts. The induced space $\text{Ind}_A^B(X)$ (unique up to unique isomorphism) is any B -space I , provided with an A -equivariant map $\varphi : X \rightarrow I$, such that for any B -space Y ,

$$\text{Hom}_B(I, Y) \xrightarrow[\varphi]{\sim} \text{Hom}_A(X, Y).$$

One has

$$\text{Ind}_A^B(X) = \coprod_{b \in B/A} b\varphi(X), \quad \varphi(X) \simeq \ker(h) \backslash X.$$

PROPOSITION 1.25. The $(G \times^Z T)^F$ -space $\tilde{X}_{TCB}$ is induced by the $(\tilde{G} \times^{\tilde{Z}} \tilde{T})^F$ -space $\tilde{X}_{\tilde{T}\tilde{C}\tilde{B}}$.

LEMMA 1.26. In the diagram

$$\begin{array}{ccccccccc} 0 & \longrightarrow & \ker & \longrightarrow & \tilde{T}^F & \longrightarrow & T^F & \longrightarrow & \text{coker} & \longrightarrow & 0 \\ & & (1) \downarrow & & (t,1) \downarrow & & (t,1) \downarrow & & (2) \downarrow & & \\ 0 & \longrightarrow & \ker & \longrightarrow & (\tilde{T} \times^{\tilde{Z}} \tilde{G})^F & \longrightarrow & (T \times^Z G)^F & \longrightarrow & \text{coker} & \longrightarrow & 0 \\ & & \downarrow & & \downarrow & & & & & & \\ & & (\tilde{G}/\tilde{Z})^F & = & (G/Z)^F & & & & & & \end{array}$$

the maps (1) and (2) are isomorphisms.

Indeed, $\tilde{T} \times^{\tilde{Z}} \tilde{G}$ (resp. $T \times^Z G$) is a $\tilde{T}$ (resp. T)-torsor over $\tilde{G}/\tilde{Z} = G/Z$, hence, since T and $\tilde{T}$ are connected, $(\tilde{T} \times^{\tilde{Z}} \tilde{G})^F$ is a $\tilde{T}^F$ -torsor over $(\tilde{G}/\tilde{Z})^F$, and $(T \times^Z G)^F$ is the induced T^F -torsor.

Proof of 1.25. By 1.26, we are reduced to prove that $\tilde{X}_{TCB}$, as a T^F -space, is induced by the $\tilde{T}^F$ -space $\tilde{X}_{\tilde{T}\tilde{C}\tilde{B}}$. The spaces $\tilde{X}_{TCB}$ and $\tilde{X}_{\tilde{T}\tilde{C}\tilde{B}}$ are

indeed respectively T^F and $\tilde{T}^F$ -torsor over $X_{T \subset B} = X_{\tilde{T} \subset \tilde{B}}$, and $X_{\tilde{T} \subset \tilde{B}}$ is hence the T^F -torsor induced by the $\tilde{T}^F$ -torsor $X_{T \subset B}$.

COROLLARY 1.27. Let θ be a character of $G^F/\pi(\tilde{G}^F)$. We denote again by θ its restriction to T^F . One has

$$R_{T \subset B}^{\theta\eta} = \theta \otimes R_{T \subset B}^{\eta}.$$

It follows from 1.25 that

$$H^*(\tilde{X}_{T \subset B}, \overline{\mathbb{Q}}_l) = \text{Ind}_{(\tilde{G} \times^{\tilde{Z}} \tilde{T})^F}^{(G \times^Z T)^F}(\tilde{X}_{\tilde{T} \subset \tilde{B}}, \overline{\mathbb{Q}}_l).$$

The character $\theta(gt)$ of $(G \times^Z T)^F$ is trivial on the image of $\tilde{G} \times^{\tilde{Z}} \tilde{T}$. The induced representation we consider is hence isomorphic to its tensor product with $\theta(gt)$, and 1.27 is a formal consequence of this.

2. Examples in the classical groups

2.1. Let V be an n -dimensional vector space over k and put $G = \text{GL}(V)$. If $b = (b_1, \dots, b_n)$ is a basis of V , we may take for T^* the group of diagonal matrices and for B^* the group of upper triangular matrices. The Weyl group lifts into the subgroup of $N(T^*)$ consisting of the w 's inducing a permutation of basis vectors. In this case, T, W (1.1), X (1.2), $E, \cdot w$ (1.7), have the following alternative description.

- (a) $T = G_m^n$, $W = \mathfrak{S}_n$, the fundamental reflections are the transpositions $(i, i+1)$ and the action of W on T is by permutation.
- (b) X is the space of complete flags $D_1 \subset \dots \subset D_{n-1}$ in V : a flag D is an increasing filtration of V with $\dim D_i = i$ for $1 \leq i \leq n-1$.
- (c) E is the space of complete flags marked by non-zero vectors

$$e_i \in D_i/D_{i-1} = \text{Gr}_i^D(V) \quad (1 \leq i \leq n),$$

where we use the convention $D_0 = 0$, $D_n = V$; T acts on E by

$$(D, (e_i))(\lambda_i) = (D, (\lambda_i e_i)).$$

This is a G -equivariant T -torsor over X .

- (d) If D' and D'' are two flags, their relative position is labelled by the permutation w such that

$$\text{Gr}_{w(i)}^{D'} \text{Gr}_i^{D''}(V) \neq 0.$$

The isomorphisms

$$\text{Gr}_{w(i)}^{D'}(V) \simeq \text{Gr}_i^{D''} \text{Gr}_{w(i)}^{D'}(V) \simeq \text{Gr}_{w(i)}^{D'} \text{Gr}_i^{D''}(V) \simeq \text{Gr}_i^{D''}(V)$$

induce a w -isomorphism between the T -torsor $E(D')$ of markings of D' and $E(D'')$:

$$e \mapsto e \cdot \dot{w}.$$

When w is the n -cycle $(1, \dots, n)$, D' and D'' are in relative position w if and only if

$$D_i'' + D_i' = D_{i+1}' \quad (1 \leq i < n-1), \quad D_{n-1}'' + D_1' = V.$$

2.2. We now take k and $\mathbb{F}_q$ as in (0.1.1) and assume that V is provided with an $\mathbb{F}_q$ -structure. Frobenius maps are then defined. For $w = (1, \dots, n)$, the condition for a flag D to be in relative position w with its image FD by Frobenius is that D be the flag

$$D_1 \subset D_1 + FD_1 \subset D_1 + FD_1 + F^2D_1 \subset \dots \quad \text{and that} \quad V = \bigoplus_{i=0}^{n-1} F^i D_1.$$

If we denote by $P(V)$ the set of homogeneous lines in V , the map $D \mapsto D_1$ is an isomorphism from $X(w)$ to the set of all $x \in P(V)$ which do not lie on any $\mathbb{F}_q$ -rational hyperplane. A marking e of F is such that $F(e) = e \cdot w$ if and only if

$$\begin{aligned} e_2 &\equiv F(e_1) \pmod{e_1}, \\ e_3 &\equiv F^2(e_1) \pmod{e_1, F(e_1)}, \dots, \\ e_n &\equiv F^{n-1}(e_1) \pmod{e_1, F(e_1), \dots, F^{n-2}(e_1)} \end{aligned}$$

and

$$e_1 \equiv F^n(e_1) \pmod{F(e_1), \dots, F^{n-1}(e_1)};$$

e is defined by $e_1 \in D_1$ subject to the condition that

$$e_1 \wedge F(e_1) \wedge \dots \wedge F^{n-1}(e_1) = F^n(e_1) \wedge F(e_1) \wedge \dots \wedge F^{n-1}(e_1),$$

i.e.:

$$F(e_1 \wedge \dots \wedge F^{n-1}(e_1)) = (-1)^{n-1}(e_1 \wedge \dots \wedge F^{n-1}(e_1)). \quad (2.2.1)$$

If (x_i) are the coordinates of e_1 with respect to some rational basis, the condition (2.2.1) can be rewritten

$$(-1)^{n-1} \left(\det(x_i^{q^{j-1}})_{1 \leq i, j \leq n} \right)^{q-1} = 1. \quad (2.2.2)$$

The form on the left is invariant under $\mathrm{GL}(n, \mathbb{F}_q)$. Up to a scalar factor, it is the product of all non-zero $\mathbb{F}_q$ -rational linear forms. The map $(D, e) \mapsto e_1$ induces an isomorphism of $\tilde{X}(w)$ with the affine hypersurface (2.2.2). This hypersurface is stable under $x \mapsto \lambda x$ for $\lambda \in \mathbb{F}_{q^n}^*$, and this is the action of $T(w)^F$.

Our work has been inspired by results of Drinfeld, who proved that the discrete series representations of $\mathrm{SL}(2, \mathbb{F}_q)$ occur in the cohomology of the affine curve

$$xy^q - x^q y = 1$$

(the form

$$xy^q - x^q y = \begin{vmatrix} x & x^q \\ y & y^q \end{vmatrix}$$

is $\mathrm{SL}_2(\mathbb{F}_q)$ -invariant).

Let $\varphi(q, r, n)$ be the number of $\mathbb{F}_{q^r}$ -rational points of $X(w)$, $r \geq 1$. We have the following

PROPOSITION 2.3.

$$\varphi(q, r, n) = \prod_{1 \leq i \leq n-1} (q^r - q^i).$$

Proof. We define a partition

$$P(V) = X_0 \cup X_1 \cup \dots \cup X_{n-1}$$

as follows: X_i is the set of points $x \in P(V)$ such that $x, F(x), F^2(x), \dots$ span a linear subspace of dimension i of $P(V)$. This partition is invariant under Frobenius, and clearly X_i has precisely

$$\varphi(q, r, i+1) \frac{(1 - q^{n-i}) \dots (1 - q^n)}{(1 - q) \dots (1 - q^{i+1})}$$

$\mathbb{F}_q$ -rational points. It follows that

$$\frac{q^{nr} - 1}{q - 1} = \sum_{0 \leq i \leq n-1} \varphi(q, r, i + 1) \frac{(1 - q^{n-i}) \cdots (1 - q^n)}{(1 - q) \cdots (1 - q^{i+1})}.$$

This shows that, for fixed n , $\varphi(q, r, n)$ is a polynomial of degree $(n - 1)$ in $Q = q^r$, with coefficient polynomials in q , and leading term Q^{n-1} . Since $\varphi(q, r, n) = 0$ for $1 \leq r \leq n - 1$, this polynomial must be divisible by $(Q - q)$, $(Q - q^2)$, ..., $(Q - q^{n-1})$. It follows that

$$\varphi(q, r, n) = (Q - q)(Q - q^2) \cdots (Q - q^{n-1})$$

and the proposition is proved.

2.4. Let V be a vector space as in (2.2), with a fixed non-degenerate symplectic form $\langle \cdot, \cdot \rangle$ defined over $\mathbb{F}_q$. We must have $n = 2m$. The symplectic group $\mathrm{Sp}(V)$ is then a group as in (0.1.1). Let Y be the set of all complete isotropic flags $D_1 \subset D_2 \subset \cdots \subset D_m$ in V ($\dim D_i = i$) such that

$$D_1 \neq FD_1 \subset D_2, \quad D_2 \neq FD_2 \subset D_3, \quad \dots, \quad D_{m-1} \neq FD_{m-1} \subset D_m, \quad D_m \neq FD_m.$$

Then Y can be identified with $X(w)$, where w is a Coxeter element in the Weyl group $\mathbf{W}$ of $\mathrm{Sp}(V)$; if we identify $\mathbf{W}$ with the group of all permutations σ of $-m, \dots, -2, -1, 1, 2, \dots, m$ such that $\sigma(-i) = -\sigma(i)$ for all i , then w is the permutation

$$\begin{aligned} -i &\mapsto -i + 1 & (2 \leq i \leq m), & & -1 &\mapsto m, \\ i &\mapsto i - 1 & (2 \leq i \leq m), & & 1 &\mapsto -m. \end{aligned}$$

On the other hand, Y (hence also $X(w)$) can be identified with the set of $x \in \mathbf{P}(V)$ such that

$$\langle x, F(x) \rangle = \langle x, F^2(x) \rangle = \cdots = \langle x, F^{m-1}(x) \rangle = 0, \quad \langle x, F^m(x) \rangle \neq 0.$$

For example, if $\dim V = 4$, this is just the set of all $x \in \mathbf{P}(V)$ such that $\langle x, F(x) \rangle = 0$, $\langle x, F^2(x) \rangle \neq 0$. Note that the equation $\langle x, F(x) \rangle = 0$ defines a non-singular surface S in $\mathbf{P}(V)$ and that $\langle x, F^2(x) \rangle \neq 0$ means that we remove from S a union of rational curves, one for each isotropic plane in V , defined over $\mathbb{F}_q$. One can prove that in this case ($n = 4$), the number of $\mathbb{F}_q$ -rational points of $X(w)$ is given by:

$$q^{2r} - \frac{q}{2}(1+q)^2 q^r + \frac{q}{2}(1-q)^2 (-q)^r + q^4 = \begin{cases} (q^r - q^2)^2, & r \text{ even}, \\ (q^r - q)(q^r - q^3), & r \text{ odd}. \end{cases}$$

3. A fixed point formula

3.1. Let X be a scheme, separated and of finite type over k and let $\sigma : X \rightarrow X$ be an automorphism of finite order of X . We decompose σ as $\sigma = s \cdot u$ where s and u are powers of σ respectively of order prime to p and

a power of p . The main result of this chapter is the following:

THEOREM 3.2. With the above notations (see also 0.5),

$$\mathrm{Tr}(\sigma^*, H_c^*(X, \overline{\mathbb{Q}}_l)) = \mathrm{Tr}(u^*, H_c^*(X^s, \overline{\mathbb{Q}}_l)).$$

The first step is to prove that the left hand side is an integer independent of l . One might conjecture that for any endomorphism f of X and each i , $\mathrm{Tr}(f^*, H_c^i(X, \overline{\mathbb{Q}}_l))$ is integral and independent of l , but such a more general and precise result is known only for X proper and smooth (Katz and Messing, *Inv. Math.* 23 (1974), 73-77).

PROPOSITION 3.3. With the notations of 3.1, $\mathrm{Tr}(\sigma^*, H_c^*(X, \overline{\mathbb{Q}}_l))$ is an integer independent of l ($l \neq p$).

A standard specialization argument allows us to assume that $p > 1$ and that k is an algebraic closure of the prime field $\mathbb{F}_p$. This is anyway the only case we will need in the rest of the paper. The scheme X and σ can then be defined over some finite extension $\mathbb{F}_q \subset k$ of $\mathbb{F}_p$; we denote by $F : X \rightarrow X$ the corresponding Frobenius endomorphism.

Let us first assume that X is quasi-projective. Then, for $n \geq 1$, the composite $F^n \circ \sigma$ is the Frobenius map relative to some new way of lowering the field of definition of X from k to $\mathbb{F}_{q^n}$ and the Lefschetz fixed point formula for Frobenius ([5] and [11]) shows that $\mathrm{Tr}((F^n \sigma)^*, H_c^*(X, \overline{\mathbb{Q}}_l))$ is the number of fixed points of $F^n \sigma$ ($n \geq 1$). The automorphisms F^* and σ^* of the cohomology commute; as a function of n , $\mathrm{Tr}((F^n \sigma)^*, H_c^*(X, \overline{\mathbb{Q}}_l))$ is hence of the form $\sum_{\lambda} \alpha_{\lambda} \lambda^n$ where λ runs through the multiplicative group $\overline{\mathbb{Q}}_l^*$ of $\overline{\mathbb{Q}}_l$ and where α_{λ} is zero for all λ except for a finite number of them.

The functions $\mathbb{N}^+ \rightarrow \overline{\mathbb{Q}}_l^* : n \mapsto \lambda^n$ (for $\lambda \in \overline{\mathbb{Q}}_l^*$) are linearly independent. This can be checked either by using Vandermonde determinants or by appealing to Dedekind's theorem on the linear independence of characters (Bourbaki, *Algèbre V*, § 7, 5). For $n \geq 1$ the numbers $\sum_{\lambda} \alpha_{\lambda} \lambda^n = |X^{F^n \sigma}|$ are rational; hence for any automorphism τ of $\overline{\mathbb{Q}}_l$ one has

$$\sum_{\lambda} \tau(\alpha_{\lambda}) \tau(\lambda)^n = \sum_{\lambda} \tau(\alpha_{\tau^{-1}(\lambda)}) \lambda^n = \sum_{\lambda} \alpha_{\lambda} \lambda^n \quad (n \geq 1),$$

and, by the linear independence of the functions λ^n ,

$$\alpha_{\tau(\lambda)} = \tau(\alpha_{\lambda}).$$

In particular, $\mathrm{Tr}(\sigma^*, H_c^*(X, \overline{\mathbb{Q}}_l)) = \sum_{\lambda} \alpha_{\lambda}$ is invariant by any automorphism of $\overline{\mathbb{Q}}_l$, hence rational. Similarly, as $\mathrm{Tr}((F^n \sigma)^*, H_c^*(X, \overline{\mathbb{Q}}_l)) = |X^{F^n \sigma}|$ is independent of l , for any isomorphism $\tau : \overline{\mathbb{Q}}_l \rightarrow \overline{\mathbb{Q}}_{l'}$ one has

$$\tau \mathrm{Tr}(\sigma^*, H_c^*(X, \overline{\mathbb{Q}}_l)) = \mathrm{Tr}(\sigma^*, H_c^*(X, \overline{\mathbb{Q}}_{l'})),$$

hence the rational number $\text{Tr}(\sigma^*, H_c^*(X, \overline{\mathbb{Q}}_l))$ is independent of l .

Since the automorphism σ has finite order, $\text{Tr}(\sigma^*, H_c^*(X, \overline{\mathbb{Q}}_l))$ is a sum of roots of unity, hence an algebraic integer. Being rational it is an ordinary integer.

If we do not assume X to be quasi-projective, we can either repeat the previous argument by working with algebraic spaces or reduce to the quasi-projective case: if (X_i) is a finite partition of X into locally closed quasi-projective subschemes stable under σ , then (cf. [5])

$$\text{Tr}(\sigma^*, H_c^*(X, \overline{\mathbb{Q}}_l)) = \sum_i \text{Tr}(\sigma^*, H_c^*(X_i, \overline{\mathbb{Q}}_l)). \quad (3.3.1)$$

3.4. Proof of 3.2. Let (X_i) be a partition of X into locally closed subschemes stable under σ and such that, on each X_i , σ defines a free action of a cyclic group. By applying (3.3.1) to the decompositions $X = \bigcup X_i$ and $X^s = \bigcup X_i^s$, one reduces to the case where σ generates a free action of a cyclic group H . In this case, either

- (a) σ is of order a power of p , hence $s = \text{Id}$, $u = \sigma$ and (3.2) is trivial, or
- (b) the order of σ is divisible by a prime number $l' \neq p$ and we must prove that $\text{Tr}(\sigma^*, H_c^*(X, \overline{\mathbb{Q}}_{l'})) = 0$. As

$$\text{Tr}(\sigma^*, H_c^*(X, \overline{\mathbb{Q}}_l)) = \text{Tr}(\sigma^*, H_c^*(X, \overline{\mathbb{Q}}_{l'})) \quad (3.3)$$

we may as well assume that $l = l'$. Let us now grant the

PROPOSITION 3.5. Let H be a finite group acting freely on X . Then

$$\chi(h) = \text{Tr}(h^*, H_c^*(X, \overline{\mathbb{Q}}_l))$$

is the character of a virtual projective $\mathbb{Z}_l[H]$ -module.

If H is abelian, and if H' is its largest subgroup of order prime to l , a representation of H over $\mathbb{Z}_l$ gives rise to a projective $\mathbb{Z}_l[H]$ -module if and only if it is induced from a representation of H' . Its character vanishes then on $H - H'$ and we get the vanishing (b) by applying (3.5) to the cyclic group generated by σ .

3.6. Let A be a torsion ring with unit and let $\mathcal{F}$ be a sheaf of left A -modules on a scheme Y , with Y separated and of finite type over k . The A -modules $H_c^i(Y, \mathcal{F})$ are then the cohomology modules of a finer object $R\Gamma_c(Y, \mathcal{F})$ in the derived category $D^b(A)$ of the category of A -modules. The following is the key to the proof of 3.5.

PROPOSITION 3.7. Assume A to be right and left noetherian. If $\mathcal{F}$ is a constructible sheaf of projective A -modules, then $R\Gamma_c(Y, \mathcal{F})$ can be represented by a finite complex of projective A -modules of finite type.

We repeat the proof in [10, XVII (5.2.10)].

- (a) The $H_c^i(Y, \mathcal{F})$ are A -modules of finite type, and vanish for $i > 2 \dim(Y)$ ([10, XVII (5.2.8.1) and (5.3.6)]).
 (b) For any right A -module of finite type N , one has

$$R\Gamma_c(Y, N \otimes_A \mathcal{F}) \simeq N \otimes_A^L R\Gamma_c(Y, \mathcal{F})$$

([10, XVII (5.2.9)]); the proof rests on replacing N by a free resolution of N , to reduce to the trivial case where N is free of finite type; we are allowed to use such left infinite resolutions because $R\Gamma_c$ is of finite cohomological dimension. The assumption that N is of finite type is in fact unnecessary.

(c) By (a) we can represent $R\Gamma_c(Y, \mathcal{F})$ by a complex of A -modules $K^\bullet$, with $K^i = 0$ for $i \notin [0, 2 \dim Y]$ and K^i free of finite type for $i > 0$. For any right A -module of finite type N and any $i > 0$,

$$\mathrm{Tor}_i^A(N, K^0) = H^{-i}(N \otimes_A^L R\Gamma_c(Y, \mathcal{F})) \stackrel{(b)}{=} H^{-i}R\Gamma_c(Y, N \otimes \mathcal{F}) = 0.$$

The A -module K^0 is hence flat; it is of finite type because $H^0(K^\bullet)$ is, hence it is projective.

3.8. Proof of 3.5. We will assume that X is quasi-projective (the general case can be handled as in 3.3). Put $Y = X/H$ and denote by π the projection $\pi : X \rightarrow Y$. The group H acts on $\pi_* \mathbb{Z}/l^n$ and this action turns $\pi_* \mathbb{Z}/l^n$ into a locally constant sheaf of free $\mathbb{Z}/l^n[H]$ -modules of rank one. By 3.7, $R\Gamma_c(Y, \pi_* \mathbb{Z}/l^n)$ can be represented by a complex $K_n^\bullet$ of projective $\mathbb{Z}/l^n[H]$ -modules of finite type. One has

$$R\Gamma_c(Y, \pi_* \mathbb{Z}/l^n) \simeq R\Gamma_c(Y, \pi_* \mathbb{Z}/l^{n+1}) \otimes_{\mathbb{Z}/l^{n+1}}^L \mathbb{Z}/l^n$$

(3.7 (b)), and one checks easily ([11, XV, 3.3, Lemme 1]) that once $K_n^\bullet$ is chosen, one can choose $K_{n+1}^\bullet$ such that $K_n^\bullet$ is the reduction mod l^n of $K_{n+1}^\bullet$. Taking a projective limit, we get a complex $K_\infty^\bullet$ of projective $\mathbb{Z}_l[H]$ -modules and an H -equivariant isomorphism

$$H_c^*(X, \mathbb{Z}_l) = \varprojlim H_c^*(X, \mathbb{Z}/l^n) = \varprojlim H_c^*(Y, \pi_* \mathbb{Z}/l^n) = H^*(K_\infty^\bullet)$$

(the middle equality because π is finite). We then have

$$\chi(h) = \sum_i (-1)^i \mathrm{Tr}(h, K_\infty^i).$$

3.9. Let X/k be as in (3.1), T a finite abelian group of order prime to p , G a finite group and ρ an action of $T \times G$ on X . We assume that the action of T on X is free. We let $T \times G$ act on $H_c^*(X)$ by transport of structure. For any character θ of T with values in $\overline{\mathbb{Q}}_l^*$, we denote by H_θ^* the subspace of $H_c^*(X)$ on which T acts by θ ; on H_θ^* , t^* is multiplication by $\theta(t)^{-1}$.

Let us assume for simplicity that X is quasi-projective. We denote by π the projection $\pi : X \rightarrow Y = X/T$. The group G acts on Y . For each $g \in G$, we denote by $I(g)$ the set of connected components of the fixed point set Y^g

and by Y_i^g the component corresponding to $i \in I(g)$.

For $y \in Y$, $\pi^{-1}(y)$ is a principal homogeneous set for the action of the abelian group T . If $y \in Y^g$, g acts on $\pi^{-1}(y)$ and commutes with T , it hence acts like some $t(g, y) \in T$:

$$gx = t(g, x)x, \quad x \in \pi^{-1}(y);$$

$t(g, y)$ is constant for y in each connected component Y_i^g of Y^g ; we denote it by $t(g, i)$.

The Theorem 3.2 will be used in the following form.

COROLLARY 3.10. With the above notations, let $g = su$ be the decomposition of $g \in G$ as the product of commuting elements respectively of order prime to p and a power of p . Then,

$$\mathrm{Tr}(g^*, H_\theta^*) = \sum_{i \in I(s)} \theta(t(s, i)^{-1}) \mathrm{Tr}(u^*, H_c^*(Y_i^s)).$$

For $t \in T$, the decomposition 3.1 of $\sigma = t \cdot g$ is $tg = (st) \cdot u$. We have

$$X^{st} = \prod_{i \in I(s)} \pi^{-1}(Y_i^s)^{st} = \prod_{\substack{i \in I(s) \\ t=t(s,i)^{-1}}} \pi^{-1}(Y_i^s),$$

hence

$$\begin{aligned} \mathrm{Tr}(g^*, H_\theta^*) &= \frac{1}{|T|} \sum_t \theta(t)^{-1} \mathrm{Tr}(g^* t^{*-1}, H_c^*(X)) \\ &= \frac{1}{|T|} \sum_t \theta(t) \mathrm{Tr}(g^* t^*, H_c^*(X)) \\ &= \frac{1}{|T|} \sum_t \theta(t) \sum_{\substack{i \in I(s) \\ t=t(s,i)^{-1}}} \mathrm{Tr}(u^*, H_c^*(\pi^{-1}(Y_i^s))) \\ &= \frac{1}{|T|} \sum_{i \in I(s)} \theta(t(s, i)^{-1}) \mathrm{Tr}(u^*, H_c^*(\pi^{-1}(Y_i^s))). \end{aligned}$$

The decomposition (3.1) of the automorphism tu of $\pi^{-1}(Y_i^s)$ is $t \cdot u$. For $t \neq e$, t has no fixed point, hence

$$\mathrm{Tr}((tu)^*, H_c^*(\pi^{-1}(Y_i^s))) = 0 \quad (t \neq e).$$

The endomorphism

$$\frac{1}{|T|} \sum_t t^* \quad \text{of} \quad H_c^*(\pi^{-1}(Y_i^s))$$

is a retraction onto the subspace $\pi^* H_c^*(Y_i^s)$, hence

$$\frac{1}{|T|} \mathrm{Tr}(u^*, H_c^*(\pi^{-1}(Y_i^s))) = \mathrm{Tr}(u^*, H_c^*(Y_i^s))$$

and, substituting into the expression for $\mathrm{Tr}(g^*, H_\theta^*)$, we get (3.10).

3.11. The end of this chapter will not be used in this paper. Let G be

a finite group acting on X/k as in (3.1). For simplicity we assume X to be quasi-projective. Assume further that G acts freely on X , and put $Y = X/G$. The covering X of Y is said to be tame if Y can be imbedded as a Zariski open dense subset of a proper scheme $\bar{Y}$ in such a way that the p -Sylow-subgroups of G act freely on the normalisation $\bar{X}$ of $\bar{Y}$ in X :

$$\begin{array}{ccc} X & \xhookrightarrow{j} & \bar{X} \\ \downarrow & & \downarrow \\ Y & \hookrightarrow & \bar{Y}. \end{array}$$

PROPOSITION 3.12. With the above notations, if X/Y is tame, then the virtual representation $\sum_i (-1)^i H_c^i(X)$ of G is a multiple of the regular representation.

It suffices to prove that $\text{Tr}(g^*, H_c^*(X)) = 0$ for $g \neq e$. If g is not of order a power of p , this follows from (3.2). If g is of order a power of p , g acts without fixed points on $\bar{X}$ and

$$\text{Tr}(g^*, H_c^*(X)) = \text{Tr}(g^*, H^*(\bar{X}, j_! \bar{Q}_l)) = 0$$

by the Lefschetz fixed point theorem applied to $\bar{X}$ and the sheaf $j_! \bar{Q}_l$.

3.13. Historical remark. The method we have followed, using (3.5), was first used by Zarelua (On finite groups of transformations, Proc. Int. Symp. on Topology and its Applications, 1968, pp. 334-339) and independently by J. L. Verdier to prove that if a finite group G acts freely on a topological space X of finite cohomological dimension, and if the $H^i(X, \mathbb{Z})$ are of finite type, then $\sum_i (-1)^i H^i(X, \mathbb{Z}) \otimes \mathbb{Q}$ is a multiple of the regular representation of G .

4. The character formula

The assumptions (0.1.1) are in force in this chapter and the next four.

DEFINITION 4.1. Let T be an F -stable maximal torus of G . The Green function $Q_{T,G}(u)$ is the restriction to the unipotent elements of the character of the virtual representation $R_{T \subset B}^1$, where B is any Borel subgroup containing T .

This Green function does not depend on B (by (1.6) and (1.17 (i))); it only depends on the G^F -conjugacy classes of T and u . The natural map $x \mapsto \bar{x}$ from G to its adjoint group induces a bijection on the unipotent sets, and

$$Q_{T,G}(u) = Q_{\bar{T},G^{\text{ad}}}(\bar{u}). \quad (4.1.1)$$

The Green function is integer-valued (3.3) and is a restriction of a character

of G^F , hence $Q_{T,G}(u) = Q_{T,G}(u^n)$ if $(n, p) = 1$.

Let α be the smallest integer ≥ 1 such that F^α is the identity on W . From the proof of (3.3) we see that $\sum_{n \geq 1} X_{T \subset B}^{F^{\alpha n}} u t^n$ is a rational function of t and that

$$Q_{T,G}(u) = - \left\{ \sum_{n \geq 1} X_{T \subset B}^{F^{\alpha n}} u t^n \right\}_{t=\infty}. \quad (4.1.2)$$

In this chapter, we will express the character of $R_{T \subset B}^\theta$ in terms of θ and of Green functions.

THEOREM 4.2. Let $x = su$ be the Jordan decomposition of $x \in G^F$. Then

$$\text{Tr}(x, R_{T \subset B}^\theta) = \frac{1}{|Z^0(s)^F|} \sum_{\substack{g \in G^F \\ \text{ad } gT \subset Z^0(s)}} Q_{\text{ad } gT, Z^0(s)}(u) \text{ad } g(\theta)(s).$$

Let ε_x be the function on G^F whose value is 1 at $x \in G^F$ and 0 elsewhere. One can rewrite 4.2 as giving the following formula for the character of $R_{T \subset B}^\theta$:

$$\text{Tr}(\cdot, R_{T \subset B}^\theta) = \sum_{t \in T^F} \frac{1}{|Z^0(t)^F|} \theta(t) \sum_{\substack{u \in Z^0(t)^F \\ g \in G^F}} Q_{T, Z^0(t)}(u) \varepsilon_{\text{ad } g(tu)} \quad (4.2.1)$$

where we put $Q_{T, Z^0(t)}(u) = 0$ whenever u is not unipotent.

COROLLARY 4.3. $R_{T \subset B}^\theta$ is independent of the choice of B ($B \supset T$).

From now on we shall write R_T^θ for $R_{T \subset B}^\theta$. We will deduce 4.2 from 3.7 and the following geometrical facts.

PROPOSITION 4.4. (i) If a Borel subgroup B_1 of G contains s , then $B_1 \cap Z^0(s)$ is a Borel subgroup of $Z^0(s)$.

(ii) Pick $T \subset B$ in G . Any Borel subgroup B_1 such that $s \in B_1$ is of the form $\text{ad } gB$ with $\text{ad } gT \subset Z^0(s)$ (i.e., $g^{-1}sg \in T$). The left coset

$$\tau_{T,B}(B_1) \stackrel{\text{def.}}{=} Z^0(s) \cdot g$$

depends only on T , B , and B_1 .

(iii) The map $B'_1 \mapsto B'_1 \cap Z^0(s)$ is an isomorphism from the space of Borel subgroups containing s , such that $\tau_{T,B}(B'_1) = \tau_{T,B}(B_1)$ and the space of Borel subgroups of $Z^0(s)$.

Proof. (i) is well known. Put $B_1 = \text{ad } g_1 B$. We have $g_1^{-1}sg_1 \in B$ hence there exists u in the unipotent radical of B such that $u^{-1}g_1^{-1}sg_1u \in T$. We take $g = g_1u$. Put $T' = \text{ad } gT$. If $g' = hg$ is also such that $\text{ad } g'B = B_1$ (resp. $\text{ad } g'T \subset Z^0(s)$) then $h \in B_1$ (resp. $h \in Z^0(s)N(T')$, by the conjugacy of maximal tori in $Z^0(s)$). If $W = N(T')/T'$ is the Weyl group of G and $W^0 = (N(T') \cap Z^0(s))/T'$ that of $Z^0(s)$, the Bruhat decomposition for $Z^0(s)$ reads

$$Z^0(s) = (B_1 \cap Z^0(s))W^0(B_1 \cap Z^0(s)),$$

and

$$(B_1 Z^0(s)) \cap N(T') = B_1 W^0(B_1 \cap Z^0(s)) \cap N(T') \subset B_1 W^0 B_1 \cap N(T') = W^0(T') \subset Z^0(s).$$

Hence

$$B_1 \cap (Z^0(s) \cdot N(T')) \subset Z^0(s)$$

and

$$B_1 \cap (Z^0(s) \cdot N(T')) = B_1 \cap Z^0(s).$$

The element g such that $\text{ad } gB = B_1$ and $\text{ad } gT \subset Z^0(s)$ is unique modulo $B_1 \cap Z^0(s)$, hence (ii) and (iii).

A $Z^0(s)$ -left coset $\tau = Z^0(s)g$, with $\text{ad } gT \subset Z^0(s)$, defines an isomorphism $\bar{\tau}$ from the maximal torus of G to that of $Z^0(s)$; $\text{ad } g$ maps T (contained in the Borel subgroup B) to $\text{ad } gT \subset Z^0(s)$ (contained in the Borel subgroup $\text{ad } gB \cap Z^0(s)$). This construction will allow us to compare the relative position of Borel subgroups in G and $Z^0(s)$.

PROPOSITION 4.5. Let B'_1 and B''_1 be Borel subgroups containing s ,

$$\tau' = \tau_{T,B}(B'_1), \quad \tau'' = \tau_{T,B}(B''_1);$$

let w be the relative position of B'_1 and B''_1 (in G) and w_1 that of $B'_1 \cap Z^0(s)$ and $B''_1 \cap Z^0(s)$ (in $Z^0(s)$). Then

$$w_1 = \bar{\tau}' w \bar{\tau}''^{-1}.$$

Replacing (T, B) by a conjugate, we may assume that $B = B'_1$ and that $T \subset B'_1 \cap Z^0(s) \cap B''_1$. We will identify the maximal torus of G and that of $Z^0(s)$ with T , using $T \subset B$ and $T \subset (B \cap Z^0(s))$. We then have $\bar{\tau}' = \text{Id}$. Replacing B''_1 by an $N(T) \cap Z^0(s)$ -conjugate, we may further assume that $w_1 = 1$, i.e., $B'_1 \cap Z^0(s) = B''_1 \cap Z^0(s)$. We must prove that $w = \bar{\tau}''$, which is clear.

LEMMA 4.6. If B and B' , containing T , are in the same relative position as B_1 and B'_1 containing s , then $\tau_{T,B}(B_1) = \tau_{T,B'}(B'_1)$.

Replacing (B, T, B') by a conjugate, we may again assume that $B = B_1$ and that $T \subset B_1 \cap Z^0(s) \cap B'_1$. In this case $B' = B'_1$.

To prove (4.2) we first compute the space $X_{T \subset B}^s$ of Borel subgroups B_1 containing s and such that B_1 and FB_1 are in the same relative position as B and FB .

PROPOSITION 4.7. Let $X_{T \subset B}^s(g)$ be the subspace of $X_{T \subset B}^s$ consisting of those B_1 with $\tau_{T,B}(B_1) = Z^0(s)g$. Then

$$X_{T \subset B}^s = \coprod_{\substack{g \in Z^0(s)^F \setminus G^F \\ \text{ad } gT \subset Z^0(s)}} X_{T \subset B}^s(g) \quad (4.7.1)$$

and, for $g \in G^F$, the map $B_1 \mapsto B_1 \cap Z^0(s)$ induces an isomorphism

$$X_{T \subset B}^s(g) \xrightarrow{\sim} X_{\text{ad } gT \subset \text{ad } gB \cap Z^0(s)}. \quad (4.7.2)$$

By 4.6, we have $F\tau_{T,B}(B_1) = \tau_{T,FB}(FB_1) = \tau_{T,B}(B_1)$. By Lang's Theorem, the $Z^0(s)$ -principal homogeneous space $\tau_{T,B}(B_1)$, being F -stable, has a rational point, hence (4.7.1). By (4.4 (iii)) and (4.5), the map (4.7.2) is an isomorphism from $X_{T \subset B}^s(g)$ to some $X(w)$ (relative to $Z^0(s)$); to check which w appears, we observe that $\text{ad } gB \in X_{T \subset B}^s(g)$.

Proof of 4.2. The theorem is now an immediate application of (4.7) and (3.10) applied to the action (1.17) of $G^F \times T^F$ on $\tilde{X}_{T \subset B}$.

5. Characters of tori

We will assume chosen isomorphisms

$$k^* \xrightarrow{\sim} (\mathbb{Q}/\mathbb{Z})_{p'}, \quad (5.0.1)$$

and

$$(\text{roots of unity of order prime to } p \text{ in } \overline{\mathbb{Q}}_l^*) \xrightarrow{\sim} (\mathbb{Q}/\mathbb{Z})_{p'}. \quad (5.0.2)$$

5.1. Let T be a torus over k . Besides the character group $X(T) = \text{Hom}(T, \mathbb{G}_m)$, we will consider its dual $Y(T) = \text{Hom}(\mathbb{G}_m, T)$. The duality is given by

$$\langle \alpha, h \rangle = \alpha \circ h \in \text{Hom}(\mathbb{G}_m, \mathbb{G}_m) = \mathbb{Z}$$

($\alpha \in X(T)$ and $h \in Y(T)$). The maps $(h, x) \mapsto h(x)$ and $t \mapsto (\alpha \mapsto \alpha(t))$ induce isomorphisms

$$Y(T) \otimes k^* = T(k) = \text{Hom}(X(T), k^*). \quad (5.1.1)$$

If T is a maximal torus in G , the roots of T in G are elements of $X(T)$, while the coroots belong to $Y(T)$. If α is a root, the corresponding coroot H_α is characterised as follows: there is a homomorphism $u : \text{SL}(2) \rightarrow G$, which maps the subgroup $\begin{pmatrix} 1 & * \\ 0 & 1 \end{pmatrix}$ onto the root subgroup U_α , and whose restriction to the group of diagonal matrices (identified with $\mathbb{G}_m$ by $x \mapsto \begin{pmatrix} x & 0 \\ 0 & x^{-1} \end{pmatrix}$) is H_α .

5.2. Using the chosen isomorphism (5.0.1), we can rewrite (5.1.1) as

$$T(k) = Y(T) \otimes (\mathbb{Q}/\mathbb{Z})_{p'} \simeq (Y(T) \otimes \mathbb{Q}/Y(T))_{p'}. \quad (5.2.1)$$

If T is obtained by extension of scalars from a torus $T_0/\mathbb{F}_q$, the Frobenius map F induces a map $F : Y(T) \rightarrow Y(T)$ (Y is a covariant functor) and T^F is the subgroup $\text{Ker}(F - 1)$ of $T(k) = Y(T) \otimes (\mathbb{Q}/\mathbb{Z})_{p'}$; since F is divisible by p , it is also the kernel of $F - 1$ in $Y(T) \otimes \mathbb{Q}/\mathbb{Z}$:

$$0 \longrightarrow T^F \longrightarrow Y(T) \otimes \mathbb{Q}/\mathbb{Z} \xrightarrow{F-1} Y(T) \otimes \mathbb{Q}/\mathbb{Z} \longrightarrow 0. \quad (5.2.2)$$

By applying the Snake Lemma to

$$\begin{array}{ccccccccc} 0 & \longrightarrow & Y(T) & \longrightarrow & Y(T) \otimes \mathbb{Q} & \longrightarrow & Y(T) \otimes \mathbb{Q}/\mathbb{Z} & \longrightarrow & 0 \\ & & \downarrow F-1 & & \downarrow F-1 & & \downarrow F-1 & & \\ 0 & \longrightarrow & Y(T) & \longrightarrow & Y(T) \otimes \mathbb{Q} & \longrightarrow & Y(T) \otimes \mathbb{Q}/\mathbb{Z} & \longrightarrow & 0, \end{array}$$

we get another exact sequence

$$0 \longrightarrow Y(T) \xrightarrow{F-1} Y(T) \longrightarrow T^F \longrightarrow 0. \quad (5.2.3)$$

The maps in (5.2.2), (5.2.3) depend on the choice (5.0.1). An intrinsic expression for these sequences would be as follows: T^F is the image of the middle map in the exact sequence

$$0 \longrightarrow Y(T)_{\hat{p}}(1) \xrightarrow{F-1} Y(T)_{\hat{p}}(1) \xrightarrow{(F-1)^{-1}} Y(T)_{\hat{p}}(1) \otimes \mathbb{Q}/\mathbb{Z} \xrightarrow{F-1} Y(T)_{\hat{p}}(1) \otimes \mathbb{Q}/\mathbb{Z} \longrightarrow 0.$$

Let us map the sequences (5.2.2), (5.2.3) into $\mathbb{Q}/\mathbb{Z}$. The isomorphism (5.0.2) provides an isomorphism

$$(T^F)^{\sim} \stackrel{\text{def}}{=} \text{Hom}(T^F, \overline{\mathbb{Q}}_l^*) = \text{Hom}(T^F, \mathbb{Q}/\mathbb{Z}),$$

and we get exact sequences

$${}^*0 \longrightarrow X(T) \xrightarrow{F-1} X(T) \longrightarrow (T^F)^{\sim} \longrightarrow 0, \quad (5.2.2)$$

$${}^*0 \longrightarrow (T^F)^{\sim} \longrightarrow X(T) \otimes \mathbb{Q}/\mathbb{Z} \xrightarrow{F-1} X(T) \otimes \mathbb{Q}/\mathbb{Z} \longrightarrow 0. \quad (5.2.3)$$

The dual torus T^* of T is defined by the rule $X(T^*) = Y(T)$, (hence $Y(T^*) = X(T)$); its $\mathbb{F}_q$ -structure is defined by $(F \text{ on } Y(T^*)) = ({}^tF \text{ on } X(T))$. Via some isomorphism

$$(T^F)^{\sim} = T^{*F}, \quad (5.2.4)$$

the sequences (5.2.3), (5.2.2) for T^* are identical with (5.2.2) * , (5.2.3) * .

5.3. If we go from $\mathbb{F}_q$ to $\mathbb{F}_{q^n}$, F is replaced by F^n . Composition with the norm map

$$N = \frac{F^n - 1}{F - 1} = \sum_0^{n-1} F^i : T^{F^n} \longrightarrow T^F$$

is an injection ${}^tN : (T^F)^{\sim} \rightarrow (T^{F^n})^{\sim}$. We have commutative diagrams

$$\begin{array}{ccccccccccc}
0 & \longrightarrow & Y & \xrightarrow{F^n-1} & Y & \longrightarrow & T^{F^n} & \longrightarrow & Y \otimes \mathbb{Q}/\mathbb{Z} & \xrightarrow{F^n-1} & Y \otimes \mathbb{Q}/\mathbb{Z} & \longrightarrow & 0 \\
& & \downarrow N & & \parallel & & \downarrow N & & \downarrow N = \sum_{i=0}^{n-1} F^i & & \parallel & & \\
0 & \longrightarrow & Y & \longrightarrow & Y & \longrightarrow & T^F & \longrightarrow & Y \otimes \mathbb{Q}/\mathbb{Z} & \longrightarrow & Y \otimes \mathbb{Q}/\mathbb{Z} & \longrightarrow & 0, \\
0 & \longrightarrow & X & \longrightarrow & X & \longrightarrow & (T^F)^\sim & \longrightarrow & X \otimes \mathbb{Q}/\mathbb{Z} & \longrightarrow & X \otimes \mathbb{Q}/\mathbb{Z} & \longrightarrow & 0 \\
& & \parallel & & \downarrow {}^t N = \sum_{i=0}^{n-1} {}^t F^i & & \downarrow {}^t N & & \parallel & & \downarrow {}^t N & & \\
0 & \longrightarrow & X & \longrightarrow & X & \longrightarrow & (T^{F^n})^\sim & \longrightarrow & X \otimes \mathbb{Q}/\mathbb{Z} & \longrightarrow & X \otimes \mathbb{Q}/\mathbb{Z} & \longrightarrow & 0.
\end{array}$$

where X and Y stand for $X(T)$ and $Y(T)$. In particular, for θ a character of T^F , θ and $\theta \circ N$ have the same image in $X(T) \otimes \mathbb{Q}/\mathbb{Z}$, and (5.2.4) gives rise to a commutative diagram

$$\begin{array}{ccc}
(T^F)^\sim & \simeq & (T^*)^F \\
\downarrow {}^t N & & \downarrow N \\
(T^{F^n})^\sim & \simeq & (T^*)^{F^n}.
\end{array}$$

PROPOSITION 5.4. Let T and T' be two F -stable maximal tori of G , and let θ, θ' be characters of $T^F, (T')^F$. We identify them with characters of $Y(T)$ and $Y(T')$, by (5.2.3). The following conditions are equivalent:

- (i) For some $x \in G$, with $\text{ad } x(T) = T'$, the map induced by $\text{ad } x : Y(T) \rightarrow Y(T')$ carries θ to θ' ;
- (ii) For some n , the pairs $(T, \theta \circ N), (T', \theta' \circ N)$, where N is the norm from T^{F^n} to T^F (resp. $(T')^{F^n}$ to $(T')^F$) are G^{F^n} -conjugate.

By 5.3, the condition (i) is invariant under the replacement of F by F^n and of θ, θ' by $\theta \circ N, \theta' \circ N$. It hence suffices to check (5.4) in the trivial case where T and T' are split.

DEFINITION 5.5. The pairs $(T, \theta), (T', \theta')$ are said to be geometrically conjugate when the equivalent conditions of (5.4) hold.

5.6. Let (T, θ) be as above. The choice of a Borel subgroup B containing T defines an isomorphism of T with the torus $\mathbf{T}$; the corresponding isomorphism $Y(T) \rightarrow Y(\mathbf{T})$ carries θ to a character of $Y(\mathbf{T})$ with values in the roots of unity of order prime to p in $\overline{\mathbb{Q}}_l$. The isomorphism (5.0.2) identifies it with an element of $X(\mathbf{T}) \otimes (\mathbb{Q}/\mathbb{Z})_{p'}$. Its class $[\theta]$ in $(X(\mathbf{T}) \otimes (\mathbb{Q}/\mathbb{Z})_{p'})/\mathbf{W}$ is independent of the choice of B . It is invariant under F . Let us put

$$\mathcal{S} \stackrel{\text{def}}{=} [(X(\mathbf{T}) \otimes (\mathbb{Q}/\mathbb{Z})_{p'})/\mathbf{W}]^F \xrightarrow{\sim} [(X(\mathbf{T}) \otimes \mathbb{Q}/\mathbb{Z})/\mathbf{W}]^F.$$

PROPOSITION 5.7. (i) The map $\theta \mapsto [\theta]$ induces a bijection from the set of geometric conjugacy classes of pairs (T, θ) to $\mathcal{S}$.

(ii) (Compare Steinberg [15, p. 93]). The number of geometric conjugacy classes of pairs (T, θ) is $|Z^{0F}|q^l$ where Z^0 is the identity component of the centre of G and l is the semisimple rank of G .

(i) The injectivity is clear on 5.4(i). Let us prove surjectivity. If the class mod $\mathbf{W}$ of $x \in X(\mathbf{T}) \otimes (\mathbb{Q}/\mathbb{Z})_p$ is invariant by F , one indeed has ${}^t(wF)x = x$ for some $w \in \mathbf{W}$, and x corresponds to a character of $\mathbf{T}(w)^F$, hence of T^F , for some F -stable maximal torus T in G (1.14).

(ii) As in (5.2), we may now identify geometric conjugacy classes of pairs (T, θ) with $\mathbb{F}_q$ -rational points of the quotient $\mathbf{T}^*/\mathbf{W}$. Our task is to compute

$$|(\mathbf{T}^*/\mathbf{W})^F| = \sum_i (-1)^i \operatorname{Tr}(F^*, H_c^i(\mathbf{T}^*/\mathbf{W})) = \sum_i (-1)^i \operatorname{Tr}(F^*, H_c^i(\mathbf{T}^*)^{\mathbf{W}}).$$

Let G' be the derived group of G ; the torus $\mathbf{T}^*$ is isogenous to (hence has the same cohomology as) the product of Z^{0*} with $\mathbf{T}'^*$ ($\mathbf{T}'$ being the torus of G'). Since any torus has as many rational points as its dual, we get by Künneth's Theorem

$$|(\mathbf{T}^*/\mathbf{W})^F| = |Z^{0F}| \sum_i (-1)^i \operatorname{Tr}(F^*, H_c^i(\mathbf{T}'^*)^{\mathbf{W}}).$$

We have

$$H^*(\mathbf{T}'^*, \overline{\mathbb{Q}}_l) = \Lambda^* H^1(\mathbf{T}'^*, \overline{\mathbb{Q}}_l) = \Lambda^*(Y(\mathbf{T}') \otimes \overline{\mathbb{Q}}_l(-1));$$

hence by Poincaré duality,

$$H_c^{2l-i}(\mathbf{T}'^*, \overline{\mathbb{Q}}_l) = \operatorname{Hom}(\Lambda^i Y(\mathbf{T}'), \overline{\mathbb{Q}}_l(i-l)),$$

and

$$\operatorname{Tr}(F^*, H_c^{2l-i}(\mathbf{T}'^*)^{\mathbf{W}}) = q^{l-i} \operatorname{Tr}(F, \Lambda^i Y(\mathbf{T}')^{\mathbf{W}}).$$

The next lemma shows that this trace is zero for $i \neq 0$, hence the q^l factor.

LEMMA 5.8. Let $W \subset \operatorname{Aut}(V)$ be a finite group generated by reflections of a real vector space V of dimension d . We assume that $V^W = 0$. Then $(\Lambda^i V)^W = 0$ for $i \neq 0$.

For a proof, see Bourbaki [1, Ch. V, Ex. 3 of § 2].

5.9. Let T be an F -stable maximal torus in G and let α be a root of T . For θ a character of T^F , we will say that θ is orthogonal to H_α : $\langle H_\alpha, \theta \rangle = 0$ if θ , viewed as a character of $Y(T)$ (5.2.3), is identically 1 on H_α . The character θ of $Y(T)$ is then invariant by the corresponding reflection s_α .

5.10. Let $\pi : \tilde{G} \rightarrow G$ be the simply connected covering of the derived group of G , and let $\tilde{T}$ be the inverse image of T in $\tilde{G}$. The group $\tilde{T}$ is

connected: it is a maximal torus in $\tilde{G}$. It acts on $T \times \tilde{G}$ by

$$\tilde{t} * (t, g) = (t\pi(\tilde{t})^{-1}, \tilde{t}g),$$

and the map $(t, g) \mapsto tg$ induces an isomorphism $\tilde{T} \backslash (T \times \tilde{G}) \xrightarrow{\sim} G$, hence (Lang's Theorem) $\tilde{T}^F \backslash (T^F \times \tilde{G}^F) \xrightarrow{\sim} G^F$. We have

$$T^F / \pi(\tilde{T}^F) \xrightarrow{\sim} G^F / \pi^F(\tilde{G}). \quad (5.10.1)$$

PROPOSITION 5.11. (i) A character of T^F is the restriction to T^F of a character of $G^F / \pi(\tilde{G}^F)$ if and only if it is orthogonal to all coroots.

(ii) Let θ be a character of $G^F / \pi(\tilde{G}^F)$, T and T' two F -stable maximal tori and let $x \in G$ be such that $\text{ad } x(T) = T'$. Then $\text{ad } x : Y(T) \rightarrow Y(T')$ carries the restriction of θ to T^F (viewed as a character of $Y(T)$) onto the restriction of θ to $(T')^F$: the restrictions of θ to the F -stable maximal tori are all geometrically conjugate.

The assertion (i) follows from (5.10.1), and the fact that $Y(\tilde{T}) \subset Y(T)$ is spanned by the coroots H_α . To prove (ii), we will use the criterion 5.4 (ii). Let n be such that $x \in G^{F^n}$. We will prove that if $y \in T^{F^n}$, $N(y)$ and $N(\text{ad } x(y))$ have the same image in $G^F / \pi(\tilde{G}^F)$, hence that $\text{ad } x$ transforms $(\theta \mid T^F) \circ N$ into $(\theta \mid (T')^F) \circ N$.

The map

$$t \mapsto N(t)^{-1}N(\text{ad } x(t)) : T \longrightarrow G$$

lifts uniquely into a map $\varphi : T \rightarrow \tilde{G}$ mapping e to e . Indeed,

(a) it factors through T/Z ;

(b) the map $t \mapsto N(t)^{-1}N(\text{ad } x(t)) : \tilde{T} \rightarrow \tilde{G}$ factors through $\tilde{T}/\tilde{Z} = T/Z$ and the desired lifting is the composite $T \rightarrow T/Z = \tilde{T}/\tilde{Z} \rightarrow \tilde{G}$.

Similarly, the map

$$(a, t) \mapsto a^{-1}N(t)^{-1}N(\text{ad } x(t))\text{ad } x(a) : T \times T \longrightarrow G$$

lifts into $\psi : T \times T \rightarrow \tilde{G}$, with $\psi(e, t) = \varphi(t)$. The identity

$$\begin{aligned} F(N(t)^{-1}N(\text{ad } x(t))) &= N(Ft)^{-1}N(F\text{ad } x(t)) \\ &= (t^{-1}F^n t)^{-1}N(t)^{-1}N(\text{ad } x(t))\text{ad } x(t^{-1}F^n)\text{ad } x(t) \\ &= (t^{-1}F^n t)^{-1}N(t)^{-1}N(\text{ad } x(t))\text{ad } x(t^{-1}F^n t) \end{aligned}$$

lifts into

$$F\varphi(t) = \psi(t^{-1}F^n t, \varphi(t)).$$

Putting $t = y$, we have $y^{-1}F^n y = e$, hence $F\varphi(y) = \varphi(y)$ and $\varphi(y) \in \tilde{G}^F$. We have $N(y)^{-1}N(\text{ad } x(y)) \in \pi(\tilde{G}^F)$, as required.

Remark 5.12. The argument above can be used to show the existence of a norm map

$$N : G^{F^n} / \pi(\tilde{G}^{F^n}) \longrightarrow G^F / \pi(\tilde{G}^F)$$

which for each F -stable maximal torus T gives rise to a commutative diagram

$$\begin{array}{ccc}
T^{F^n} / \pi(\widetilde{T}^{F^n}) & \xrightarrow{\sim} & G^{F^n} / \pi(\widetilde{G}^{F^n}) \\
N \downarrow & & N \downarrow \\
T^F / \pi(\widetilde{T}^F) & \xrightarrow{\sim} & G^F / \pi(\widetilde{G}^F).
\end{array}$$

THEOREM 5.13. Let (T, θ) be as above. We use (5.2.3) to identify θ with a character of $Y(T)$. If the centre of G is connected, then the stabilizer of θ in the Weyl group $W = N(T)/T$ is generated by the reflections s_α , for H_α a coroot orthogonal to θ .

The key point in the proof is the same as in Steinberg's Theorem that if the derived group G' is simply connected, then the centralizer of any semisimple element is connected.

Let us identify θ with the corresponding element in $X(T) \otimes (\mathbb{Q}/\mathbb{Z})_{p'}$ (invariant under F). Let $\theta_1 \in X(T) \otimes \mathbb{Q}$ be a representative for it. This θ_1 has no p in the denominator. We have the dictionary:

- (a) $\langle H_\alpha, \theta \rangle = 0 \iff \langle H_\alpha, \theta_1 \rangle \in \mathbb{Z}$;
- (b) θ is fixed by $w \in W \iff$ for some $x \in X(T)$, $w\theta_1 + x = \theta_1$.

Let X^{ad} be the subgroup of X generated by the roots. It is the character group of the image T^{ad} of T in the adjoint group. The character group of the centre $Z = \text{Ker}(T \rightarrow T^{\text{ad}})$ of G is X/X^{ad} ; the character group of Z/Z_{red}^0 is the torsion subgroup of X/X^{ad} , hence

- (c) Z is connected and smooth (resp. connected) if and only if X/X^{ad} is torsion free (resp. has no torsion prime to p).

For each root α , $s_\alpha(\theta_1) = \theta_1 - \langle H_\alpha, \theta_1 \rangle \alpha$. The number $\langle H_\alpha, \theta_1 \rangle$ has no p in the denominator; hence $\langle H_\alpha, \theta_1 \rangle \alpha \in X(T)$ if and only if $\langle H_\alpha, \theta_1 \rangle \in \mathbb{Z}$; $s_\alpha(\theta) = \theta$ if and only if $\langle H_\alpha, \theta \rangle = 0$. It remains to check that the stabilizer of θ is generated by the reflections it contains.

Fix N such that $(1/p^N)X^{\text{ad}} \supset X \cap (X^{\text{ad}} \otimes \mathbb{Q})$ and such that $p^N \equiv 1 \pmod{\text{order of } \theta}$. For any $w \in W$, $w\theta_1 - \theta_1$ is in $X^{\text{ad}} \otimes \mathbb{Q}$, hence if $w\theta_1 - \theta_1$ is in X , $w(p^N\theta_1) - (p^N\theta_1) \in X^{\text{ad}}$. Replacing θ_1 by $p^N\theta_1$, which is also a representative of θ , we may assume that θ is fixed by $w \in W$ if and only if $w\theta_1 + x = \theta_1$ for some $x \in X^{\text{ad}}$. The stabilizer of θ in W is the image in W of the stabilizer of θ_1 in the affine Weyl group. It remains to apply Bourbaki [1, Ch. VI, Ex. 1 of § 2].

Remark 5.14. The proof shows that, if we use a suitable Borel subgroup $B \supset T$ to identify W with $\mathbf{W}$, the stabilizer of θ becomes the subgroup of $\mathbf{W}$ generated by some of the reflections corresponding either to a simple root or to the negative of the highest coroot.

DEFINITION 5.15. (i) The character θ of T^F is nonsingular if it is not

orthogonal to any coroot.

(ii) θ is in general position if it is not kept fixed by any non-trivial element of $(N(T)/T)^F$.

PROPOSITION 5.16. If the centre of G is connected, a character is non-singular if and only if it is in general position.

The stabilizer of θ in $N(T)/T$ is a group generated by reflections, and is stable by Frobenius. We have to prove that the subgroup fixed by Frobenius is non-trivial. This follows from the next lemma.

LEMMA 5.17. Let $V \neq \{0\}$ be a euclidian vector space, and let W be a finite group generated by orthogonal reflections. We assume that $V^W = \{0\}$. If a belongs to the normalizer A of W in $O(V)$, the centralizer W^a of a in W is non-trivial.

(a) Reduction to the irreducible case. Let $V = \bigoplus V_i$ be the decomposition of V as a direct sum of irreducible root systems; we have $W = \prod W_i$. The automorphism a permutes the V_i ; by taking a direct factor, we may assume that it permutes them cyclically: $V = \bigoplus_{i \in \mathbb{Z}/n} V_i$ and $aV_i = V_{i+1}$. An element $w = (w_i) \in W = \prod W_i$ is in W^a if and only if $w_i = \text{ad } a^i(w_0)$ and w_0 is fixed by a^n ; we are reduced to proving that $W_0^{a^n}$ is non-trivial.

(b) In the irreducible case, one always has either $A = W \cup -W$ or $-1 \in W$; both cases are clear.

COROLLARY 5.18. For any G , if θ is in general position, then θ is non-singular.

Let us embed G in a group G_1 with connected centre and the same derived group. For instance, one can take $G_1 = G \times T/\{(z, z^{-1}) \mid z \in Z(G)\}$. The torus T is then contained in an F -stable maximal torus T_1 of G_1 , and θ is the restriction to T^F of some character θ_1 of T_1^F . If θ is in general position, θ_1 is so a fortiori, hence non-singular (5.16). A character θ_1 of T_1^F is non-singular if and only if its restriction to T^F is, hence (5.18).

When all roots of G have the same length, geometric conjugacy can be given the following convenient description.

DEFINITION 5.19. (Assuming all roots to be of the same length) Let T be an F -stable maximal torus and let θ be a character of T^F . The connected centralizer $S(T, \theta)$ of (T, θ) in G is the F -stable reductive subgroup of G with maximal torus T and with root subgroups relative to T the U_α for which $\langle H_\alpha, \theta \rangle = 0$.

If $\langle H_\alpha, \theta \rangle = \langle H_\beta, \theta \rangle = 0$ and $\alpha + \beta$ is a root, then $H_{\alpha+\beta} = H_\alpha + H_\beta$,

hence $\langle H_{\alpha+\beta}, \theta \rangle = 0$ and the definition makes sense. Let $\pi : \widetilde{S(T, \theta)} \rightarrow S(T, \theta)$ be the simply connected covering of the derived subgroup of $S(T, \theta)$. By 5.11 (i), θ extends to a character θ_s of $S(T, \theta)^F / \pi(\widetilde{S(T, \theta)})^F$.

PROPOSITION 5.20. If the centre of G is connected and all roots are of the same length, then a pair (T', θ') is geometrically conjugate to (T, θ) if and only if $(S(T, \theta), \theta_s)$ and $(S(T', \theta'), \theta'_s)$ are G^F -conjugate.

The “if” part follows from 5.11. Conversely, let (T', θ') be geometrically conjugate to (T, θ) : for some $x \in G$, $\text{ad } x(T) = T'$ and $\text{ad } x : Y(T) \rightarrow Y(T')$ maps θ to θ' (via (5.2.3)). If $F' : T' \rightarrow T'$ is the Frobenius map of T' , $\text{ad } x^{-1}(F') = \text{ad } wF$ for some w in the Weyl group of T . We have ${}^t F\theta = \theta$, and ${}^t(\text{ad } wF)\theta = \theta$, hence θ is fixed by w , which by part (i) belongs to the Weyl group of T in $S(T, \theta)$. Let $T'' = \text{ad } y(T)$, $y \in S(T, \theta)$, be an F -stable torus in $S(T, \theta)$, with Frobenius F'' , such that $(\text{ad } y)^{-1}(F'') = (\text{ad } x)^{-1}(F')$. Replacing (T, θ) by $(T'', \text{ad } y(\theta))$ (by applying 5.11) and replacing x by xy^{-1} , we are reduced to the case where $\text{ad } xF = F' \text{ad } x$. In this case, (T, θ) and (T', θ') are G^F -conjugate; the identity $\text{ad } x(Ft) = F' \text{ad } x(t)$ for $t \in T$ amounts to $x^{-1}Fx \in T$; and replacing x by xt^{-1} with $t \in T$, $t^{-1}Ft = x^{-1}Fx$, makes x rational.

When roots are not all of the same length, one has to work in the dual group G^* of G .

DEFINITION 5.21. A group G^* dual to G is a reductive group G^* defined over $\mathbb{F}_q$, whose maximal torus T^* is provided with an isomorphism with the dual of the maximal torus T of G , this isomorphism carrying simple roots to simple coroots.

Here are some properties of this duality. Let G and G^* be dual.

(5.21.1) G and G^* have the same Weyl group W . The action of W on $Y(T^*)$ is the contragredient of its action on $Y(T)$.

(5.21.2) However, Frobenius does not act in the same way on W in G and G^* : it acts in inverse ways (the origin of this is that F on $Y(T^*)$ is the transpose of F on $Y(T)$).

(5.21.3) The conjugacy classes of pairs (T, B) (T an F -stable maximal torus, B a Borel subgroup containing it) in G and G^* correspond. With the notations of (1.13), (1.14), to the class of (T, B) we associate the class of (T^*, B^*) with

$${}^t(\text{ad } h(T, B)^{-1} \circ F) = \text{ad } h(T^*, B^*)^{-1} \circ {}^t F;$$

the tori T and T^* are in duality.

(5.21.4) This induces a bijection between the rational conjugacy classes of maximal tori in G and G^* . If T and T' are in corresponding classes, we have a natural class (mod $(N(T)/T)^F$) of isomorphisms between T^* and T' .

(5.21.5) Let T be an F -stable torus on G , and let θ be a character of T^F . Fix T' , a corresponding torus in G^* . The character θ defines an element of T'^F , then a $(N(T')/T')^F$ -conjugacy class of elements θ' of T' . In that way, we get a bijection between G^F -conjugacy classes of pairs (T, θ) as above, and G^{*F} -conjugacy classes of pairs (T', θ') , T' an F -stable maximal torus of G^* and θ' an element of T'^F . This correspondence is compatible with extension of scalars from $\mathbb{F}_q$ to $\mathbb{F}_{q^n}$ (cf. 5.3.).

(5.21.6) By forgetting T' , we see that each G^F -conjugacy class of pairs (T, θ) defines an element $\theta' \in G^{*F}$, well-defined up to G^{*F} -conjugacy.

PROPOSITION 5.22. Two pairs (T_1, θ_1) and (T_2, θ_2) are geometrically conjugate if and only if θ'_1 and θ'_2 are geometrically conjugate.

An extension of scalars (cf. 5.4, 5.5) reduces us to the case where T_1 and T_2 are split. Conjugating, we may assume further that $T_1 = T_2$. In this case, geometric conjugacy is W -conjugacy, and the proposition is clear.

PROPOSITION 5.23. Let G and G^* be dual. Then, the centre of G is connected and smooth (resp. connected) if and only if the derived group of G^* is simply connected (resp. if its simply connected covering is unseparable).

Put $Y = Y(T^*)$, T^* the maximal torus of G^* ; let Y_1 be the subgroup generated by the coroots; and put $Y_2 = Y \cap Y_1 \otimes \mathbb{Q}$. Then, Y_2 is the Y -group of the maximal torus of the derived group, and Y_1 that of the maximal torus of its universal covering. The group of this covering is the dual of the Pontrjagin dual of Y_2/Y_1 , and (5.23) follows by comparison with point (c) in the proof of (5.13).

COROLLARY 5.24. If the centre of G is connected, two pairs (T_1, θ_1) , (T_2, θ_2) as in (5.22) are geometrically conjugate if and only if θ'_1 and θ'_2 are G^{*F} -conjugate.

Indeed, by a theorem of Steinberg, geometric conjugacy amounts in this case (5.23) to conjugacy, for semi-simple elements of G^* (their centralizers are connected).

DEFINITION 5.25. Let (T', θ') correspond to (T, θ) as in (5.21.5). The pair (T, θ) is maximally split if the $\mathbb{F}_q$ -rank of T is equal to that of the centralizer of θ' , i.e., if T' is maximally split in that centralizer.

Any geometric conjugacy class of pairs (T, θ) contains maximally split pairs.

PROPOSITION 5.26. If the centre of G is connected, two geometrically conjugate maximally split pairs (T_1, θ_1) , (T_2, θ_2) are G^F -conjugate.

Via (5.21.5) and (5.24), this amounts to the known fact that two maximally split maximal tori in the centralizer $Z(\theta')$ of a semi-simple element θ' of G^{*F} are conjugate by an element of $Z(\theta)^F$.

PROPOSITION 5.27. If (T, θ) is maximally split, and the image of T in the adjoint group is anisotropic, then θ is non-singular.

Fix (T', θ') as in (5.21.5). By assumption, $Z^0(\theta')$ contains no non-central F -stable split torus, hence $Z^0(\theta') = T'$. The roots of T' in $Z^0(\theta')$ correspond to the coroots of T orthogonal to θ , hence the proposition.

COROLLARY 5.28. If (T, θ) is maximally split, T is contained in an F -stable Levi subgroup L of an F -stable parabolic subgroup P , and, in L , (T, θ) is non-singular.

One chooses P and L so that the image of T in the adjoint group of L is anisotropic. Being maximally split in G , (T, θ) is a fortiori maximally split in L , and one applies (5.27).

The following result will be used in the next chapter.

PROPOSITION 5.29. Let T' be a subtorus of a torus T , with T defined over $\mathbb{F}_q$ (no assumption on T'). Let θ be a character of T^F . It is trivial on $T' \cap T^F$ if and only if, when viewed as a character of $Y(T)$, it is trivial on

$$((F-1)Y(T') \otimes \mathbb{Q} \cap Y(T)).$$

The condition is that $\theta(x) = 0$ for

$$(F-1)^{-1}(x) \in (Y(T') \otimes \mathbb{Q} + Y(T)),$$

i.e., for

$$x \in ((F-1)Y(T') \otimes \mathbb{Q} \cap Y(T)) + ((F-1)Y(T)).$$

The character θ being trivial on $(F-1)Y(T)$, this means $\theta(x)$ is trivial for $x \in ((F-1)Y(T') \otimes \mathbb{Q} \cap Y(T))$.

6. Intertwining numbers

6.1. Let T, T' be two F -stable maximal tori in G and let θ, θ' be characters of T^F and T'^F . We put $N_G(T, T') = \{g \in G \mid Tg = gT'\}$ and

$$W_G(T, T') = T \backslash N_G(T, T') = N_G(T, T')/T'.$$

We will drop the index G if there is no ambiguity. F acts on $W(T, T')$, and

$$W(T, T')^F = T^F \backslash N(T, T')^F = N(T, T')^F / T'^F.$$

THEOREM 6.2. If θ^{-1} is not geometrically conjugate to θ' , then

$$\left[H_c^*(\tilde{X}_{T \subset B})_\theta \otimes H_c^*(\tilde{X}_{T' \subset B'})_{\theta'} \right]^{G^F} = 0,$$

i.e., if an irreducible representation of G^F occurs in $H_c^*(\tilde{X}_{T \subset B})_\theta$, its dual does not occur in $H_c^*(\tilde{X}_{T' \subset B'})_{\theta'}$.

The virtual representation $R_T^{\theta^{-1}}$ is the dual of R_T^θ (as can be seen on the character formula 4.2), hence we have as a corollary:

COROLLARY 6.3. If θ and θ' are not geometrically conjugate, no irreducible representation of G^F can occur in both virtual representations R_T^θ and $R_{T'}^{\theta'}$.

The proof of 6.2 will make use of the following homotopy argument:

PROPOSITION 6.4. Let H be a connected algebraic group acting on a scheme Y , separated and of finite type over k . For any $h \in H$, the action of h on $H_c^*(Y, \mathbb{Z}/n)$ is trivial.

Let π be the projection of $H \times Y$ onto H and let $f : H \times Y \rightarrow H \times Y$ be defined by $f(h, y) = (h, hy)$:

$$\begin{array}{ccc} H \times Y & \xrightarrow{f} & H \times Y \\ & \searrow \pi & \swarrow \pi \\ [-1ex] & H & \end{array}$$

By the change-of-basis theorem in cohomology with compact support applied to

$$\begin{array}{ccc} H \times Y & \longrightarrow & Y \\ \downarrow & & \downarrow \\ H & \longrightarrow & \text{Spec } k, \end{array}$$

$R^i \pi_* \mathbb{Z}/n$ is the constant sheaf $H_c^i(Y, \mathbb{Z}/n)$ on H . The automorphism f acts on it and, at $h \in H$, it acts the way h acts on $H_c^i(Y, \mathbb{Z}/n)$. At the identity element of H , the action of f is trivial. An endomorphism of a constant sheaf over a connected base is constant, hence f acts trivially everywhere, and the proposition is proved.

COROLLARY 6.5. The conclusion of (6.4) holds in l -adic cohomology.

The proof is a passage to limit.

6.6. Proof of 6.2. On $\tilde{X}_{T \subset B} \times \tilde{X}_{T' \subset B'}$ we have commuting actions of G^F , T^F , and T'^F (G^F acts diagonally). By Künneth's Theorem, we have to prove that

$$\left[H_c^*(\tilde{X}_{T \subset B} \times \tilde{X}_{T' \subset B'})_{\theta, \theta'} \right]^{G^F} = 0,$$

where the symbol $M_{\theta, \theta'}$, applied to any $T^F \times T'^F$ -module M , means the subspace

of M , where T^F and T'^F act by θ and θ' .

$$\begin{cases} \text{Let } U \text{ (resp. } U') \text{ be the unipotent radical of } B \text{ (resp. } B'). \\ \text{Let } S_{T \subset B} = \{g \in G \mid g^{-1}Fg \in FU\}, \quad S_{T' \subset B'} = \{g' \in G \mid g'^{-1}Fg' \in FU'\}. \end{cases}$$

The unipotent group $(U \cap FU) \times (U' \cap FU')$ acts freely on $S_{T \subset B} \times S_{T' \subset B'}$ and the orbit space is $\tilde{X}_{T \subset B} \times \tilde{X}_{T' \subset B'}$ (see (1.17)). It follows that

$$H_c^i(\tilde{X}_{T \subset B} \times \tilde{X}_{T' \subset B'})(-d) \simeq H_c^{i+2d}(S_{T \subset B} \times S_{T' \subset B'}),$$

where d is the dimension of $(U \cap FU) \times (U' \cap FU')$. This isomorphism is compatible with the action of $G^F \times T^F \times T'^F$; moreover this group acts trivially on $\tilde{Q}_l(-d)$. Hence it is sufficient to prove that

$$H_c^*(S_{T \subset B} \times S_{T' \subset B'})_{\theta, \theta'}^{G^F} = H_c^*((S_{T \subset B} \times S_{T' \subset B'})/G^F)_{\theta, \theta'} = 0.$$

The map

$$(g, g') \mapsto (x, x', y), \quad x = g^{-1}Fg, \quad x' = g'^{-1}Fg', \quad y = g^{-1}g',$$

defines an isomorphism of $(S_{T \subset B} \times S_{T' \subset B'})/G^F$ with

$$\tilde{S} = \{(x, x', y) \in FU \times FU' \times G \mid xF(y) = yx'\}.$$

Under this isomorphism, $T^F \times T'^F$ acts on $\tilde{S}$ by the formula

$$(x, x', y) \mapsto (t^{-1}xt, t'^{-1}x't', t^{-1}yt'), \quad (t, t') \in T^F \times T'^F. \quad (6.6.1)$$

Let U'^- be opposed to U' with respect to T' . Any $g \in G$ can be written uniquely in the form $g = u_g n_g u'_g$, with $u_g \in U \cap n_g U'^- n_g^{-1}$, $n_g \in N(T, T')$ (see (6.1)), $u'_g \in U'$; this follows easily from Bruhat's Lemma. For any $w \in W(T, T')$, let G_w be the set of all $g \in G$ such that n_g represents w . Then $(G_w)_{w \in W(T, T')}$ is a finite partition of G into locally closed subschemes. It has the property (6.6.2) below, expressing the fact that the closure of a Bruhat cell is a union of Bruhat cells.

(6.6.2.) For a suitable ordering of $W(T, T')$, the unions

$$\Sigma_w = \bigcup_{w' < w} G_{w'}$$

are closed.

Let $\tilde{S}_w = \{(x, x', y) \in \tilde{S} \mid y \in G_w\}$. Then $(\tilde{S}_w)_{w \in W(T, T')}$ is a finite partition of $\tilde{S}$ into locally closed subschemes, stable under $T^F \times T'^F$. It inherits a property analogous to (6.6.2), that is, the unions $\bigcup_{w' < w} \tilde{S}_{w'}$ are closed for any w .

The spectral sequence associated to the filtration of $\tilde{S}$ by these unions shows that, in order to prove that $H_c^*(\tilde{S})_{\theta, \theta'} = 0$, it is sufficient to prove that $H_c^*(\tilde{S}_w)_{\theta, \theta'} = 0$ for any $w \in W(T, T')$.

Let

$$H_w = \{(t, t') \in T \times T' \mid t'F(t')^{-1} = F(\dot{w})^{-1}tF(t)^{-1}F(\dot{w})\},$$

where $\dot{w} \in N(T, T')$ represents w . Then H_w is a closed subgroup of $T \times T'$, containing $T^F \times T'^F$. We define an action of H_w on $\tilde{S}_w$ as follows. Let $(t, t') \in H_w$; for $(x, x', y) \in \tilde{S}_w$ define

$$f_{t,t'}(x, x', y) = (\tilde{x}, \tilde{x}', \tilde{y}),$$

where

$$\begin{aligned}\tilde{x} &= t^{-1}x F(u_y) t F(t^{-1}u_y^{-1}t), \\ \tilde{x}' &= t'^{-1}x' F(u'_y)^{-1} t' F(t'^{-1}u'_y t'), \\ \tilde{y} &= t^{-1}y t'.\end{aligned}$$

It is easy to check that $(\tilde{x}, \tilde{x}', \tilde{y}) \in \bar{S}_w$, hence $f_{t,t'} : \bar{S}_w \longrightarrow \bar{S}_w$. It is also easy to check that

$$f_{t_1,t'_1} \circ f_{t_2,t'_2} = f_{t_1 t_2, t'_1 t'_2}$$

for $(t_i, t'_i) \in H_w$, $i = 1, 2$, hence $f_{t,t'}$ defines an action of H_w on $\bar{S}_w$. It is clear that this action extends the action (6.6.1) of $T^F \times T'^F$ on $\bar{S}_w$. The theorem now follows from 6.5 and the

LEMMA 6.7. If the character $\theta\theta'$ of $T^F \times T'^F$ is trivial on $H_w^0 \cap (T^F \times T'^F)$, then $\theta'^{-1} = \theta \circ \text{ad}(F(w))$ (as characters of $Y(T')$).

The subgroup H_w of $T \times T'$ is the kernel of the composite map

$$T \times T' \xrightarrow{x^{-1}Fx} T \times T' \xrightarrow{t^{-1} \text{ad } F(w)(t')} T.$$

Applying the functor Y , we get that $Y(H_w^0)$ is the kernel K of

$$Y(T) \times Y(T') \xrightarrow{Fx-x} Y(T) \times Y(T') \xrightarrow{\text{ad } F(w)(x')-x} Y(T).$$

By (5.29), the triviality of $\theta\theta'$ on $H_w^0 \cap (T^F \times T'^F)$ means that, when we view $\theta\theta'$ as a character of $Y(T) \times Y(T')$, it is trivial on

$$(F-1)(K \otimes \mathbb{Q}) \cap (Y(T) \times Y(T')).$$

Since the map $F-1$ is injective, this intersection is

$$\text{Ker}(\text{ad } F(w)(x') - x : Y(T) \times Y(T') \longrightarrow Y(T))$$

and the assumption becomes the triviality of $\theta\theta'$ on $\text{Ker}(\text{ad } F(w)(x') - x)$, i.e., the identity

$$\theta \circ \text{ad } F(w)(\theta') = 1.$$

We will now conjugate (6.2) with the character formula (4.2) to get quantitative results.

THEOREM 6.8. Let $\theta \in (T^F)^\vee$, $\theta' \in (T'^F)^\vee$. Then

$$\langle R_T^\theta, R_{T'}^{\theta'} \rangle_{G^F} = \#\{w \in W(T, T')^F \mid \text{ad } w(\theta') = \theta\}.$$

THEOREM 6.9.

$$\frac{1}{|G^F|} \sum_{\substack{u \in G^F \\ \text{unipotent}}} Q_{T,G}(u) Q_{T',G}(u) = \frac{|N(T, T')^F|}{|T^F| |T'^F|}. \quad (6.9.1)$$

We will prove (6.8) and (6.9) simultaneously, by induction on the dimension of G .

LEMMA 6.10. If (6.9) holds, for G replaced by $Z^0(s)$, where $s \in G^F$ is any semisimple element not contained in the centre Z of G , then

$$\langle R_T^\theta, R_{T'}^{\theta'} \rangle_{G^F} = \#\{w \in W(T, T')^F \mid \text{ad } w(\theta') = \theta\} + \alpha \quad (6.10.1)$$

where

$$\alpha = \sum_{s \in T^F \cap Z} \theta(s) \theta'(s^{-1}) \left(\frac{1}{|G^F|} \sum_{\substack{u \in G^F \\ \text{unipotent}}} Q_{T,G}(u) Q_{T',G}(u) - \frac{|N(T, T')^F|}{|T^F| |T'^F|} \right).$$

In particular, (6.9) implies (6.8).

According to (4.2) we have:

$$\begin{aligned} \langle R_T^\theta, R_{T'}^{\theta'} \rangle &= \frac{1}{|G^F|} \sum_{g_1 \in G^F} \text{Tr}(g_1, R_T^\theta) \text{Tr}(g_1^{-1}, R_{T'}^{\theta'}) \\ &= \frac{1}{|G^F|} \sum_{\substack{s \in G^F \\ \text{semis.}}} \frac{1}{|Z^0(s)^F|^2} \sum_{\substack{g, g' \in G^F \\ g^{-1}sg \in T^F \\ g'^{-1}sg' \in T'^F}} \theta(g^{-1}sg) \theta'(g'^{-1}sg')^{-1} \\ &\quad \times \sum_{\substack{u \in Z^0(s)^F \\ \text{unipotent}}} Q_{gTg^{-1}, Z^0(s)}(u) Q_{g'T'g'^{-1}, Z^0(s)}(u). \end{aligned}$$

With our assumption, this can be written as

$$\begin{aligned} \alpha + \frac{1}{|G^F|} \sum_{\substack{s \in G^F \\ \text{semis.}}} \frac{1}{|Z^0(s)^F|} \sum_{\substack{g, g' \in G^F \\ g^{-1}sg \in T^F \\ g'^{-1}sg' \in T'^F}} \theta(g^{-1}sg) \theta'(g'^{-1}sg')^{-1} \\ \times \frac{|N_{Z^0(s)}(gTg^{-1}, g'T'g'^{-1})^F|}{|T^F| |T'^F|}. \end{aligned}$$

The formula $(g, g', n_1) \mapsto (g, n, n_1)$, $n = g'^{-1}n_1g$, establishes a one-to-one correspondence between the sets

$$\begin{aligned} \{(g, g', n_1) \in G^F \times G^F \times G^F \mid g^{-1}sg \in T^F, g'^{-1}sg' \in T'^F, \\ n_1 \in N_{Z^0(s)}(gTg^{-1}, g'T'g'^{-1})^F\}, \\ \{(g, n, n_1) \in G^F \times N_G(T, T')^F \times Z^0(s)^F \mid g^{-1}sg \in T^F\}. \end{aligned}$$

It follows that

$$\begin{aligned} \langle R_T^\theta, R_{T'}^{\theta'} \rangle &= \alpha + \frac{1}{|G^F|} \sum_{\substack{s \in G^F \\ \text{semis.}}} \frac{1}{|Z^0(s)^F|} \sum_{\substack{g \in G^F \\ n \in N_G(T, T')^F \\ g^{-1}sg \in T^F}} \theta(g^{-1}sg) \theta'(ng^{-1}sgn^{-1})^{-1} \frac{|Z^0(s)^F|}{|T^F| |T'^F|} \\ &= \alpha + \frac{1}{|G^F|} \sum_{\substack{t \in T^F \\ n \in N_G(T, T')^F}} \theta(t) \theta'(ntn^{-1})^{-1} \frac{|G^F|}{|T^F| |T'^F|} \\ &= \alpha + \frac{1}{|T'^F|} \sum_{n \in N_G(T, T')^F} \frac{1}{|T^F|} \sum_{t \in T^F} \theta(t) \theta'(ntn^{-1})^{-1} \\ &= \alpha + \#\{w \in W(T, T')^F \mid \text{ad } w(\theta') = \theta\}, \end{aligned}$$

and (6.10.1) is proved.

Proof of 6.9. Let $\tilde{G} = G/Z$; the centre of $\tilde{G}$ consists of the identity element. Both sides of (6.9.1) remain unchanged when G is replaced by $\tilde{G}$; for

the left hand side this follows from (4.1.1), while for the right hand side this is easy to check. Hence in order to prove (6.9), we may assume that the centre of G has a single element; moreover we may assume by induction that the conclusion of (6.9) is true for G replaced by $Z^0(s)$, where $s \in G^F$ is an arbitrary non-central semisimple element, and for any two F -stable maximal tori in $Z^0(s)$. (To start the induction we may take G to be the group with only one element in which case (6.9) is clear.) It follows from (6.3) that for any non-trivial character θ of T^F one has

$$\langle R_T^\theta, R_{T'}^1 \rangle = 0.$$

Substituting this information into (6.10), we see that if T^F has any non-trivial character, then $\alpha = 0$ which proves (6.9). A similar argument applies when $|T'^F| \neq 1$. It remains to check the special case where $|T^F| = |T'^F| = 1$. In this case, we must have $q = 2$, and T, T' must be $\mathbb{F}_q$ -split tori. In particular, T and T' are conjugate under G^F , hence

$$\#\{w \in W(T, T')^F \mid \text{ad } w(\theta') = \theta\} = |W(T)^F| = |W(T)|.$$

Moreover R_T^1 and $R_{T'}^1$ are both equal to the representation of G^F induced by the unit representation of B^F , where B is an F -stable Borel subgroup of G . It follows that

$$\langle R_T^1, R_{T'}^1 \rangle = |B^F \backslash G^F / B^F| = |W(T)|. \quad (1.10)$$

Substituting in (6.10) we get (6.9) in this case. This completes the proof of (6.9) (and of (6.8) by (6.10)).

7. Computations on semisimple elements

The following result describes the Euler characteristic of the scheme $X_{T \subset B}$. Let $\sigma(G)$ (resp. $\sigma(T)$) be the $\mathbb{F}_q$ -rank of G (resp. T).

THEOREM 7.1.

$$\chi(X_{T \subset B}) = Q_{T, G}(e) = (-1)^{\sigma(G) - \sigma(T)} \frac{|G^F|}{\text{St}_G(e)|T^F|}.$$

(Here St_G is the Steinberg representation of G^F , identified with its character.)

We may assume that the centre of G is reduced to a single element and that the statement is true when G is replaced by $Z^0(s)$, where $s \in G^F$ is any non-central semisimple element.

We first assume that T^F has a non-trivial character θ . The Steinberg representation occurs in

$$R_{T^*}^1 = \text{Ind}_{B^{*F}}^{G^F}(1)$$

($T^* \subset B^*$ as in 1.8), hence, by (6.3), it does not occur in R_T^θ : $\langle R_T^\theta, \text{St}_G \rangle = 0$. It is known that

$$\text{St}_G(g) = \begin{cases} (-1)^{\sigma(G) - \sigma(Z^0(g))} \text{St}_{Z^0(g)}(e), & g \in G^F \text{ semisimple,} \\ 0, & g \in G^F \text{ non-semisimple.} \end{cases}$$

If we use 4.2, it follows:

$$\sum_{s \in G^F} (-1)^{\sigma(G) - \sigma(Z^0(s))} \frac{\text{St}_{Z^0(s)}(e)}{|Z^0(s)^F|} \sum_{\substack{g \in G^F \\ g^{-1}sg \in T}} Q_{gTg^{-1}, Z^0(s)}(e) \theta(g^{-1}sg) = 0$$

(sum over the semisimple elements s of G^F).

By our assumption, we may substitute

$$Q_{gTg^{-1}, Z^0(s)}(e) = (-1)^{\sigma(Z^0(s)) - \sigma(T)} \frac{|Z^0(s)^F|}{\text{St}_{Z^0(s)}(e)|T^F|},$$

for all $s \neq e$:

$$\begin{aligned} \frac{(-1)^{\sigma(G) - \sigma(T)}}{|T^F|} \sum_{\substack{s \in G^F \\ s \neq e}} \sum_{\substack{g \in G^F \\ g^{-1}sg \in T^F}} \theta(g^{-1}sg) + \text{St}_G(e) Q_{T,G}(e) &= 0, \\ (-1)^{\sigma(G) - \sigma(T)} \frac{|G^F|}{|T^F|} \sum_{\substack{t \in T^F \\ t \neq e}} \theta(t) + \text{St}_G(e) Q_{T,G}(e) &= 0. \end{aligned}$$

Since the character θ is non-trivial, $\sum_{t \in T^F} \theta(t) = 0$ and the desired formula for $Q_{T,G}(e)$ follows.

In the case where $|T^F| = 1$, T must be an $\mathbb{F}_q$ -split torus and $q = 2$. In this case, $Q_{T,G}(e) = |G^F|/|B^{*F}|$, where B^* is any F -stable Borel subgroup (1.8). This agrees with the statement of the theorem and ends the proof.

COROLLARY 7.2. For any semisimple element $s \in G^F$,

$$\text{Tr}(s, R_T^\theta) = (-1)^{\sigma(Z^0(s)) - \sigma(T)} \frac{1}{\text{St}_{Z^0(s)}(e)|T^F|} \sum_{\substack{g \in G^F \\ g^{-1}sg \in T^F}} \theta(g^{-1}sg).$$

This follows from (7.1) and 4.2. An equivalent statement is:

PROPOSITION 7.3.

$$(-1)^{\sigma(G) - \sigma(T)} R_T^\theta \otimes \text{St}_G = \text{Ind}_{T^F}^{G^F}(\theta).$$

PROPOSITION 7.4. If θ is a non-singular character of T^F (5.19) then $(-1)^{\sigma(G) - \sigma(T)} R_T^\theta$ can be represented by an actual G^F -module. If θ is in general position (5.15), $(-1)^{\sigma(G) - \sigma(T)} R_T^\theta$ is irreducible.

By embedding G in a group G_1 with connected centre and the same derived group, as in (5.18), we reduce to the case where θ is in general position. It remains to use (6.8) and (7.1).

PROPOSITION 7.5. Let $s \in G^F$ be a semisimple element. The character of

$$\frac{1}{\text{St}_G(s)} \sum_{\substack{T \\ s \in T}} \sum_{\theta \in (T^F)^\vee} \theta(s)^{-1} (-1)^{\sigma(G) - \sigma(T)} R_T^\theta \quad (7.5.1)$$

equals $|Z(s)^F|$ on elements conjugate to s in G^F and zero on all other elements of G^F .

Let μ be the character of (7.5.1) and let μ' be the class function on G^F defined by

$$\mu'(g) = \begin{cases} |Z(s)^F|, & g \text{ conjugate to } s \text{ in } G^F, \\ 0, & \text{otherwise.} \end{cases}$$

In order to prove that $\mu = \mu'$ it is sufficient to prove that

$$\langle \mu, \mu \rangle = \langle \mu, \mu' \rangle = \langle \mu', \mu' \rangle \quad (\text{see (0.3)}).$$

We have $\langle \mu', \mu' \rangle = |Z(s)^F|$; from (6.8) we see that

$$\begin{aligned} \langle \mu, \mu \rangle &= \frac{1}{\text{St}_G(s)^2} \sum_{\substack{T \ni s \\ T' \ni s}} \sum_{\substack{\theta \in (T^F)^\vee \\ \theta' \in (T'^F)^\vee}} \theta(s^{-1})\theta'(s) \#\{n \in N(T, T')^F \mid \text{ad } n(\theta') = \theta\} |T^F|^{-1} \\ &= \frac{1}{\text{St}_G(s)^2} \sum_{\substack{T \ni s \\ \theta \in (T^F)^\vee \\ n \in G^F \\ nsn^{-1} \in T}} \theta(s^{-1})\theta(nsn^{-1}) |T^F|^{-1} \\ &= \frac{1}{\text{St}_G(s)^2} \#\{T \ni s, n \in G^F \mid sn = ns\} \\ &= \frac{|Z(s)^F|}{\text{St}_G(s)^2} \#\{F\text{-stable maximal tori in } Z^0(s)\} = |Z(s)^F| \end{aligned}$$

(by [15, Cor. 14.16]).

By (7.2), we have

$$\begin{aligned} \langle \mu, \mu' \rangle &= \mu(s) = \frac{1}{\text{St}_G(s)} \sum_{\substack{T \\ s \in T}} \sum_{\theta \in (T^F)^\vee} \theta(s^{-1}) \frac{(-1)^{\sigma(G) - \sigma(Z^0(s))}}{\text{St}_{Z^0(s)}(e) |T^F|} \sum_{\substack{g \in G^F \\ g^{-1}sg \in T^F}} \theta(g^{-1}sg) \\ &= \frac{1}{\text{St}_G(s)^2} \sum_{\substack{T \\ s \in T}} \sum_{\substack{g \in G^F \\ g^{-1}sg \in T^F}} |T^F|^{-1} \theta(s^{-1}) \theta(g^{-1}sg) \\ &= \frac{1}{\text{St}_G(s)^2} \#\{T \ni s, g \in G^F \mid sg = gs\} \\ &= \frac{|Z(s)^F|}{\text{St}_G(s)^2} \#\{F\text{-stable maximal tori in } Z^0(s)\} = |Z(s)^F|, \end{aligned}$$

and the proposition is proved.

COROLLARY 7.6. For any $\rho \in \mathcal{R}(G^F)$ and any semisimple element $s \in G^F$,

$$\text{Tr}(s, \rho) = \frac{1}{\text{St}_G(s)} \sum_{\substack{T \\ s \in T}} \sum_{\theta \in (T^F)^\vee} \theta(s) (-1)^{\sigma(G) - \sigma(T)} \langle \rho, R_T^\theta \rangle. \quad (7.6.1)$$

In particular, if $s \in G^F$ and is regular semisimple, contained in a unique torus T ,

$$\text{Tr}(s, \rho) = \sum_{\theta \in (T^F)^\vee} \theta(s) \langle \rho, R_T^\theta \rangle, \quad (7.6.2)$$

$$\dim \rho = \frac{1}{\text{St}_G(e)} \sum_T \sum_{\theta \in (T^F)^\vee} (-1)^{\sigma(G) - \sigma(T)} \langle \rho, R_T^\theta \rangle. \quad (7.6.3)$$

COROLLARY 7.7. For any irreducible representation ρ of G^F there exists an F -stable maximal torus T and a character θ of T^F such that $\langle \rho, R_T^\theta \rangle \neq 0$.

This follows from (7.6.3).

DEFINITION 7.8. An irreducible representation ρ of G^F is said to be unipotent if $\langle \rho, R_T^1 \rangle \neq 0$ for some F -stable maximal torus T .

By (6.3) and (7.7), ρ is unipotent if and only if $\langle \rho, R_T^\theta \rangle = 0$ for any F -stable maximal torus T and any $\theta \in (T^F)^\vee$, $\theta \neq 1$. For example, any irreducible component of $\text{Ind}_{B^{*F}}^{G^F}(1)$ (B^{*F} an F -stable Borel subgroup) is a unipotent representation. For unipotent representations, (7.6) becomes:

PROPOSITION 7.9. Let ρ be a unipotent representation of G^F and let $s \in G^F$ be a semisimple element. Then

$$\text{Tr}(s, \rho) = \frac{1}{\text{St}_G(s)} \sum_{\substack{T \\ s \in T}} (-1)^{\sigma(G) - \sigma(T)} \langle \rho, R_T^1 \rangle.$$

In particular, if $s \in G^F$ is regular semisimple contained in a unique maximal torus T , $\text{Tr}(s, \rho) = \langle \rho, R_T^1 \rangle$ and

$$\dim \rho = \frac{1}{\text{St}_G(e)} \sum_T (-1)^{\sigma(G) - \sigma(T)} \langle \rho, R_T^1 \rangle.$$

It follows that if B is an F -stable Borel subgroup of G and T is an F -stable maximal torus in B , we have $\text{Tr}(s, \rho) = \langle \rho, \text{Ind}_{B^F}^{G^F}(1) \rangle$; in the case where $\langle \rho, \text{Ind}_{B^F}^{G^F}(1) \rangle \neq 0$, this is a result of Curtis, Kilmoyer and Seitz (see C. W. Curtis, On the Values of Certain Irreducible Characters of Finite Chevalley Groups, *Ist. Naz. di Alta Mat. Symp. Mat.* XIII, 1974, 343–355).

PROPOSITION 7.10. Let G^{ad} be the adjoint group of G . Then, the restriction to G^F of a unipotent representation of $(G^{\text{ad}})^F$ is irreducible; non-isomorphic unipotent representations have non-isomorphic restrictions; and every unipotent representation of G is such a restriction.

It suffices to check that, if σ, τ are unipotent representations of $(G^{\text{ad}})^F$, then $\langle \sigma, \tau \rangle_{G^{\text{ad}}F} = \langle \sigma, \tau \rangle_{G^F}$. Let G_1 be the image of G^F in $(G^{\text{ad}})^F$. One has

$$\begin{aligned} \langle \sigma, \tau \rangle_{G^F} &= \langle \sigma, \tau \rangle_{G_1} = \left\langle \text{Ind}_{G_1}^{G^{\text{ad}}F}(\text{Res } \sigma), \tau \right\rangle_{G^{\text{ad}}F} \\ &= \sum_{\theta \in (G^{\text{ad}}F/G_1^F)^\vee} \langle \sigma \otimes \theta, \tau \rangle_{G^{\text{ad}}F}. \end{aligned}$$

By the exclusion theorem 6.3 and (1.23), (1.27), $\langle \sigma \otimes \theta, \tau \rangle_{G^{\text{ad}}F} = 0$ for $\theta \neq 1$, hence the proposition.

PROPOSITION 7.11. Let ρ be a virtual representation of G^F such that $\text{Tr}(su, \rho) = \text{Tr}(s, \rho)$ for any $s \in G^F$ semisimple, $u \in G^F$ unipotent, $su = us$. Let T be an F -stable maximal torus and let θ be a character of T . Then

$$\langle \rho, R_T^\theta \rangle_{G^F} = (-1)^{\sigma(G) - \sigma(T)} \langle \rho \otimes \text{St}_G, R_T^\theta \rangle_{G^F} = \langle \rho, \theta \rangle_{T^F}.$$

The Steinberg character is integral valued, hence by (7.3),

$$(-1)^{\sigma(G)-\sigma(T)} \langle \rho \otimes \text{St}_G, R_T^\theta \rangle_{G^F} = \langle \rho, (-1)^{\sigma(G)-\sigma(T)} \text{St}_G \otimes R_T^\theta \rangle_{G^F} = \langle \rho, \text{Ind}_{T^F}^{G^F}(\theta) \rangle_{G^F} = \langle \rho, \theta \rangle_{T^F}.$$

We now prove the identity

$$\langle \rho, R_T^\theta \rangle_{G^F} = \langle \rho, \theta \rangle_{T^F}. \quad (7.11.1)$$

The special case of this identity

$$\langle 1, R_T^1 \rangle_{G^F} = 1 \quad (7.11.2)$$

follows from the fact that the Euler characteristic of $X_{T \subset B}/G^F$ (which is the same as the Euler characteristic of

$$\{g \in G \mid g^{-1}Fg \in FU\}/G^F \times T^F = FU/T^F$$

by (1.17)) equals 1. If we use (4.2), (7.11.2) can be written in the form

$$\frac{1}{|G^F|} \sum_{\substack{s \in G^F \\ \text{semis.}}} \frac{1}{|Z^0(s)^F|} \sum_{\substack{g \in G^F \\ g^{-1}sg \in T^F}} \sum_{\substack{u \in Z^0(s)^F \\ \text{unipotent}}} Q_{gTg^{-1}, Z^0(s)}(u) = 1. \quad (7.11.3)$$

This implies, by induction on the dimension of G , that

$$\frac{1}{|G^F|} \sum_{\substack{u \in G^F \\ \text{unipotent}}} Q_{T, G}(u) = \frac{1}{|T^F|}. \quad (7.11.4)$$

Indeed, by substituting (7.11.4) in (7.11.3) we find a true identity:

$$\frac{1}{|G^F|} \sum_{\substack{s \in G^F \\ \text{semis.}}} \frac{1}{|T^F|} \#\{g \in G^F \mid g^{-1}sg \in T^F\} = 1.$$

We apply (4.2) again and use (7.11.4) to compute:

$$\begin{aligned} \langle \rho, R_T^\theta \rangle_{G^F} &= \frac{1}{|G^F|} \sum_{\substack{s \in G^F \\ \text{semis.}}} \frac{1}{|Z^0(s)^F|} \sum_{\substack{g \in G^F \\ g^{-1}sg \in T^F}} \sum_{\substack{u \in Z^0(s)^F \\ \text{unipotent}}} Q_{gTg^{-1}, Z^0(s)}(u) \theta(g^{-1}sg)^{-1} \text{Tr}(s, \rho) \\ &= \frac{1}{|G^F|} \sum_{\substack{s \in G^F \\ \text{semis.}}} \sum_{\substack{g \in G^F \\ g^{-1}sg \in T^F}} \frac{1}{|T^F|} \theta(g^{-1}sg)^{-1} \text{Tr}(s, \rho) \\ &= \frac{1}{|G^F|} \sum_{t \in T^F} \theta(t)^{-1} \text{Tr}(t, \rho) = \langle \rho, \theta \rangle_{T^F}. \end{aligned}$$

PROPOSITION 7.12. Let ρ be as in (7.11). Then

$$\rho = \sum_{(T)} \frac{1}{|W(T)^F|} \sum_{\theta \in (T^F)^\vee} \langle \rho, \theta \rangle_{T^F} R_T^\theta, \quad (7.12.1)$$

$$\rho \otimes \text{St}_G = \sum_{(T)} \frac{(-1)^{\sigma(G)-\sigma(T)}}{|W(T)^F|} \sum_{\theta \in (T^F)^\vee} \langle \rho, \theta \rangle_{T^F} R_T^\theta, \quad (7.12.2)$$

where $\sum_{(T)}$ means sum over all G^F -conjugacy classes of F -stable maximal tori T .

The character of $\rho \otimes \text{St}_G$ is a linear combination of the form $\sum_{(T, \theta)} c_{T, \theta} R_T^\theta$ (sum over all G^F -conjugacy classes of pairs (T, θ)). The coefficients $c_{T, \theta}$ are

determined by (7.11) and (7.12.2) follows.

Now let ρ' (resp. ρ'') be the right hand side of (7.12.1) (resp. (7.12.2)). We have clearly

$$\langle \rho', \rho' \rangle = \langle \rho'', \rho'' \rangle \quad (7.12.3)$$

and by (7.11),

$$\langle \rho, \rho' \rangle = \langle \rho \otimes \text{St}_G, \rho'' \rangle. \quad (7.12.4)$$

We note also that

$$\langle \rho, \rho \rangle = \langle \rho \otimes \text{St}_G, \rho \otimes \text{St}_G \rangle. \quad (7.12.5)$$

This follows from the fact that the number of unipotents in $Z^0(s)^F$ equals $\text{St}_G(s)^2$ for any semisimple element $s \in G^F$ (see [15, Thm. 15.1]). By (7.12.2) we have

$$\langle \rho \otimes \text{St}_G - \rho'', \rho \otimes \text{St}_G - \rho'' \rangle = 0.$$

This, together with (7.12.3), (7.12.4) and (7.12.5) implies:

$$\langle \rho - \rho', \rho - \rho' \rangle = 0,$$

hence

$$\rho = \rho'.$$

Remark 7.13. It is known that

$$\langle \rho, \rho \rangle_{G^F} = \sum_{(T)} \frac{1}{|W(T)^F|} \langle \rho, \rho \rangle_{T^F}$$

(N. Kawanaka, A theorem on finite Chevalley groups, Osaka J. Math. 10 (1973), 1–13); this could be also deduced from (7.12.1) and (6.8).

COROLLARY 7.14.

$$1 = \sum_{(T)} \frac{1}{|W(T)^F|} R_T^1. \quad (7.14.1)$$

$$\text{St}_G = \sum_{(T)} \frac{(-1)^{\sigma(G) - \sigma(T)}}{|W(T)^F|} R_T^1. \quad (7.14.2)$$

In particular,

$$\langle \text{St}_G, R_T^1 \rangle = (-1)^{\sigma(G) - \sigma(T)}.$$

Here is an alternative proof of (7.14.1). In the language of (1.4), (7.14.1) asserts that

$$\sum_{w \in W} R^1(w) = |W| \cdot 1.$$

Since $(X(w))_{w \in W}$ is a partition of the flag manifold into locally closed subschemes, we have

$$\sum_{w \in W} R^1(w) = \sum_i (-1)^i H_c^i(X_G)$$

as virtual representations of G^F . The action of G^F on X_G is the restriction of the action of the connected group G ; by (6.5), G^F acts trivially on $H_c^*(X_G)$ and it remains to use the fact that the Euler characteristic of X_G equals $|W|$.

COROLLARY 7.15.

$$\text{St}_G = \sum_{(T)} \frac{(-1)^{\sigma(G) - \sigma(T)}}{|W(T)^F|} \text{Ind}_{T^F}^{G^F}(1), \quad (7.15.1)$$

$$\text{St}_G \otimes \text{St}_G = \sum_{(T)} \frac{1}{|W(T)^F|} \text{Ind}_{T^F}^{G^F}(1). \quad (7.15.2)$$

This follows from (7.1) by tensoring with St_G , and using (7.3). The formula (7.15.1) is due to B. Srinivasan (On the Steinberg character of a finite simple group of Lie type, J. Australian Math. Soc. 12 (1971), 1–14).

8. Induced and cuspidal representations

8.1. Let P be an F -stable parabolic subgroup of G and let $T \subset P$ be an F -stable maximal torus. We denote by U_P the unipotent radical of P . The quotient group P/U_P is a connected reductive algebraic group acted on by F . Let $\pi : P \rightarrow P/U_P$ be the canonical projection. π induces an isomorphism $T \xrightarrow{\sim} \pi(T)$ hence also an isomorphism $T^F \xrightarrow{\sim} \pi(T)^F$. Let θ be a character of T^F and let $\bar{\theta}$ be the corresponding character of $\pi(T)^F$. We denote by $R_{T,P}^\theta$ the image of the virtual representation $R_{\pi(T)}^{\bar{\theta}}$ of $(P/U_P)^F$ under the canonical embedding $\mathcal{R}((P/U_P)^F) \subset \mathcal{R}(P^F)$. With these notations, we have the following generalisation of 1.10:

PROPOSITION 8.2.

$$R_T^\theta = \text{Ind}_{P^F}^{G^F}(R_{T,P}^\theta).$$

We choose a Borel subgroup B in G such that $T \subset B \subset P$. Let $\mathcal{P}$ be the set of all parabolic subgroups P' in G such that P' and P are conjugate under G^F ; this is a finite set. We have

$$\tilde{X}_{T \subset B} = \prod_{P' \in \mathcal{P}} \tilde{X}(P')$$

where

$$\tilde{X}(P') = \{g \in G \mid g^{-1}Fg \in FU, \ gPg^{-1} = P'\}/U \cap FU,$$

with U the unipotent radical of B .

(Note that $g^{-1}F(g) \in FU$ implies $F(gPg^{-1}) = gPg^{-1}$.) Let $P' \in \mathcal{P}$ and let $g_1 \in G^F$ be such that $g_1Pg_1^{-1} = P'$. If $g \in G$, $g^{-1}F(g) \in FU$, $gPg^{-1} = P'$, we have

$$g_1^{-1}g \in P, \quad (g_1^{-1}g)^{-1}F(g_1^{-1}g) \in FU;$$

by sending g to $\pi(g_1^{-1}g)$ we get an isomorphism

$$\tilde{X}(P') \xrightarrow{\sim} \tilde{X}_{\pi(T) \subset \pi(B)}.$$

It follows easily that the G^F -module $H_c^i(\tilde{X}_{T \subset B})$ is canonically isomorphic to the G^F -module induced by $H_c^i(\tilde{X}_{\pi(T) \subset \pi(B)})$ regarded as a P^F -module; moreover this isomorphism is compatible with the action of T^F . The proposition follows.

THEOREM 8.3. Let T be an F -stable maximal torus in G such that T is not contained in any F -stable, proper parabolic subgroup of G . Let θ be a non-singular character of T^F (cf. 5.19). Then $(-1)^{\sigma(G)-\sigma(T)} R_T^\theta$ can be represented by a cuspidal G^F -module.

Applying (7.5) for s equal to the identity element of G^F , we see that the regular representation of G^F is equal to:

$$\text{Ind}_e^{G^F}(1) = \frac{1}{\text{St}_G(e)} \sum_T \sum_{\theta \in (T^F)^\vee} (-1)^{\sigma(G)-\sigma(T)} R_T^\theta.$$

We apply this formula with G replaced by P/U_P (P as in (8.1)); we then regard the regular representation of $(P/U_P)^F$ as a representation of P^F on which U_P^F acts trivially (i.e., as $\text{Ind}_{U_P^F}^{P^F}(1)$) and we induce it to G^F :

$$\begin{aligned} \text{Ind}_{U_P^F}^{G^F}(1) &= \text{Ind}_{P^F}^{G^F}(\text{Ind}_{U_P^F}^{P^F}(1)) \\ &= \frac{1}{\text{St}_{P/U_P}(e)} \sum_{T' \subset P/U_P} \sum_{\theta' \in (T'^F)^\vee} (-1)^{\sigma(P/U_P)-\sigma(T')} \text{Ind}_{P^F}^{G^F}(R_{T'}^{\theta'}), \end{aligned}$$

where $R_{T'}^{\theta'}$ is regarded as an element in $\mathcal{R}(P^F)$ in the natural way. We now use (8.2) and the fact that any F -stable maximal torus T' in P/U_P can be lifted to an F -stable maximal torus T in P in precisely $|U_P^F|$ different ways:

$$\text{Ind}_{U_P^F}^{G^F}(1) = \frac{1}{\text{St}_G(e)} \sum_{T \subset P} \sum_{\theta \in (T^F)^\vee} (-1)^{\sigma(G)-\sigma(T)} R_T^\theta. \quad (8.3.1)$$

If $P \neq G$ and T is as in the statement of the theorem, we see from (8.3.1) and (6.8) that

$$\left\langle (-1)^{\sigma(G)-\sigma(T)} R_T^\theta, \text{Ind}_{U_P^F}^{G^F}(1) \right\rangle = 0 \quad \text{for any } \theta \in (T^F)^\vee. \quad (8.3.2)$$

If θ is non-singular, $(-1)^{\sigma(G)-\sigma(T)} R_T^\theta$ can be represented by an actual G^F -module (7.4). This G^F -module is cuspidal by (8.3.2).

9. A Vanishing Theorem

9.1. Let G be a reductive algebraic group over k . Let $w = s_1 \cdots s_n$ be a minimal expression for an element of the Weyl group W of G (0.4). The following desingularization of the closure $\overline{O(w)}$ of $O(w) \subset X \times X$ (1.2) has been considered by H. C. Hansen [6] and M. Demazure [3].

DEFINITION 9.2. $\overline{O}(s_1, \dots, s_n)$ is the space of sequences $(B_0, \dots, B_n)$ of

Borel subgroups, with B_{i-1} and B_i in relative position e or s_i .

The maps

$$\overline{O}(s_1, \dots, s_n) \longrightarrow \overline{O}(s_1, \dots, s_{n-1}) \longrightarrow \dots \longrightarrow \overline{O}() = X$$

express $\overline{O} = \overline{O}(s_1, \dots, s_n)$ as an iterated fibre space over X , with fibre $\mathbb{P}^1$ (1.2). The subspace $D_i \subset \overline{O}$ where $B_{i-1} = B_i$ is the inverse image of a section of $\overline{O}(s_1, \dots, s_i) \rightarrow \overline{O}(s_1, \dots, s_{i-1})$; it is a smooth divisor, and $D = \bigcup D_i$ is a divisor with normal crossings. The map $(B_0, \dots, B_n) \mapsto (B_0, B_n)$ induces an isomorphism $\overline{O} - D \xrightarrow{\sim} O(w)$, and hence maps $\overline{O}$ to $\overline{O}(w)$: $\overline{O}$ is a resolution of singularities for $O(w)$.

9.3. Let T^* , B^* and U^* be as in (1.7). For any character $\lambda : T^* \rightarrow G_m$, the T^* -torsor E over X defined in (1.7) gives rise to a line bundle E_λ , provided with $\lambda : E \rightarrow E_\lambda$ such that $\lambda(et) = \lambda(e)\lambda(t)$. For $\dot{w} \in N(T^*)$ with image w in $W = N(T^*)/T^*$, the w -map of T^* -torsors over $O(w) \subset X \times X$ constructed in (1.7) induces an isomorphism

$$\Psi(\dot{w}) : \mathrm{pr}_1^* E_\lambda \xrightarrow{\sim} \mathrm{pr}_2^* E_{\lambda \circ \mathrm{ad} \dot{w}} = \mathrm{pr}_2^* E_{w^{-1}(\lambda)}$$

which makes the following diagram commute:

$$\begin{array}{ccc} \mathrm{pr}_1^* E & \xrightarrow{\dot{w}} & \mathrm{pr}_2^* E \\ \lambda \downarrow & & \downarrow w^{-1}(\lambda) \\ \mathrm{pr}_1^* E_\lambda & \xrightarrow{\Psi(\dot{w})} & \mathrm{pr}_2^* E_{w^{-1}(\lambda)}. \end{array}$$

We will investigate its behaviour at infinity.

9.4. Let $X(T^*)$ be the character group of T^* and let $C \subset X(T^*) \otimes \mathbb{R}$ be the fundamental chamber (corresponding to B^*). If C_1 and C_2 are two chambers, we write $D(C_1, C_2)$ for the intersection of the (closed) radicial half spaces containing both C_1 and C_2 , and $D^0(C_1, C_2)$ for its interior.

PROPOSITION 9.5. Let $\overline{O(w)}$ be the normalization of the closure $\overline{O(w)}$ of $O(w)$ in $X \times X$. The map $\Psi(\dot{w}) : \mathrm{pr}_1^* E_\lambda \rightarrow \mathrm{pr}_2^* E_{w^{-1}(\lambda)}$ extends over $\overline{O(w)}$ if and only if $\lambda \in D(C, -wC)$. It vanishes outside of $O(w)$ if and only if $\lambda \in D^0(C, -wC)$.

Let us consider $\Psi(\dot{w})$ as a rational section of $\mathrm{pr}_1^* E_{\lambda^{-1}} \otimes \mathrm{pr}_2^* E_{w^{-1}(\lambda)}$; it suffices to prove that, with the notations of (9.2), for each i , the order v_i of $\Psi(\dot{w})$ along the divisor $D_i \subset \overline{O}(s_1, \dots, s_n)$ is ≥ 0 for $\lambda \in D(C, -wC)$, > 0 for $\lambda \in D^0(C, -wC)$. The convex region $D(C, -wC)$ is the intersection of the radicial half spaces containing C but not wC . Put $w_i = s_1 \cdots s_i$. The gallery $(C, w_1 C, w_2 C, \dots, wC)$ connects C to wC ; its walls are all the radicial hyperplanes that separate C and wC . The wall between $w_{i-1}C$ and $w_i C$ is defined

by the root $w_{i-1}(\alpha_i)$, where α_i is the simple root corresponding to s_i ; C and $w_{i-1}C$ are on the same side of it. The convex region $D(C, -wC)$ is hence defined by the inequalities

$$\langle \mu, H_{w_{i-1}(\alpha_i)} \rangle \geq 0.$$

(Recall that H_α denotes the coroot corresponding to a root α , cf. (5.1).) We will prove that

$$v_i = \langle \lambda, H_{w_{i-1}(\alpha_i)} \rangle. \quad (9.5.1)$$

Let us lift the decomposition $w = (s_1 \cdots s_{i-1})s_i(s_{i+1} \cdots s_n)$ into a decomposition $\dot{w} = \dot{w}_{i-1}\dot{s}_i\dot{w}'_i$ in $N(T^*)$. We have

$$\Psi(\dot{w}) = \Psi(\dot{w}'_i)\Psi(\dot{s}_i)\Psi(\dot{w}_{i-1}).$$

When we approach a general point of D_i , the isomorphisms $\Psi(\dot{w}'_i)$ and $\Psi(\dot{w}_{i-1})$ extend, and we are left to prove that the order along D_i of

$$\Psi(\dot{s}_i) : E_{w_{i-1}^{-1}(\lambda)} \longrightarrow E_{w_i^{-1}(\lambda)}$$

is

$$\langle \lambda, H_{w_{i-1}(\alpha_i)} \rangle = \langle w_{i-1}^{-1}(\lambda), H_{\alpha_i} \rangle;$$

we are reduced to the case where w is a fundamental reflection: all computations occur within a minimal parabolic subgroup P , or P/U_P , or the derived group of P/U_P , or its universal covering $\mathrm{SL}(2)$. Let us make a direct check for $G = \mathrm{SL}(2)$, $w \neq e$ and λ the fundamental weight.

(a) We take $\mathrm{SL}(2)$ in its obvious representation k^2 , $T^* =$ diagonal matrices, $B^* =$ upper triangular matrices. The weight λ is

$$\begin{pmatrix} a & * \\ 0 & a^{-1} \end{pmatrix} \mapsto a, \quad \text{and} \quad \langle \lambda, H_\alpha \rangle = 1.$$

(b) $X = \mathbb{P}^1$, the space of homogeneous lines of k^2 and the fibre of E_λ at x is the corresponding line.

(c) Up to a scalar, $\Psi(\dot{w})$ associates to $u \in (E_\lambda)_x$ the linear form $u \wedge v$ on $(E_\lambda)_y$, for $x \neq y$. It vanishes simply for $y \rightarrow x$.

9.6. The assumptions (0.1.1) are in force from now on. Under the assumptions of (1.8), we have

$$F^*E_\lambda = E_{F^*\lambda} \quad (\text{where } F^*\lambda = \lambda \circ F).$$

On the inverse image $\overline{X(w)'}^{\prime}$ of the graph of the Frobenius map $F : X \rightarrow X$ in $\overline{O(w)'}^{\prime}$, the line bundle $\mathrm{pr}_1^* E_{\lambda^{-1}} \otimes \mathrm{pr}_2^* E_{w^{-1}(\lambda)}$ is hence isomorphic to

$$\mathrm{pr}_1^*(E_{F^*w^{-1}\lambda-\lambda}).$$

It will be ample if $E_{F^*w^{-1}\lambda-\lambda}$ is ample on X , i.e., if $F^*w^{-1}\lambda - \lambda \in -C^0$. On the

other hand, if $\lambda \in D^0(C, -wC)$, the section $\Psi(w)$ of it has as zero set the complement of $X(w)$ in the projective variety $\overline{X(w)}$. If both conditions can be simultaneously fulfilled, then $X(w)$ is affine. In terms of $\mu = -w^{-1}(\lambda)$, the conditions read

$$\mu \in D^0(C, -w^{-1}C), \quad (9.6.1)$$

$$F^*\mu - w\mu \in C^0. \quad (9.6.2)$$

THEOREM 9.7. If there is $\mu \in X(T^*) \otimes \mathbb{R}$ satisfying (9.6.1) and (9.6.2) then $X(w)$ is affine. As a consequence, $X(w)$ is affine as soon as q is larger than the Coxeter number h of G .

It remains to prove that if $q \geq h$, then some μ satisfies (9.6.1) and (9.6.2). The first condition will be fulfilled if $\mu \in C^0$, that is, if $\langle \mu, H_\alpha \rangle > 0$ for each simple root α . We take μ so that $\langle \mu, H_\alpha \rangle = 1$ for each simple root α . We then have $\langle F\mu, H_\alpha \rangle = q$, and $\langle w\mu, H_\alpha \rangle = \langle \mu, w^{-1}H_\alpha \rangle$. If $H = \sum n_\alpha H_\alpha$ is the highest coroot, $\sum n_\alpha = h - 1$ and

$$\langle F\mu - w\mu, H_\alpha \rangle \geq q - \langle \mu, H \rangle = q - h + 1 > 0,$$

hence (9.6.2).

THEOREM 9.8. If the character $\theta : T(w)^F \rightarrow \overline{\mathbb{Q}}_l^*$ is non-singular, then

$$H_c^*(\tilde{X}(w), \overline{\mathbb{Q}}_l)_\theta \xrightarrow{\sim} H^*(\tilde{X}(w), \overline{\mathbb{Q}}_l)_\theta.$$

COROLLARY 9.9. If $X(w)$ is affine and θ is non-singular, then

$$H_c^i(\tilde{X}(w), \overline{\mathbb{Q}}_l)_\theta = 0 \quad \text{for } i \neq l(w).$$

Let us deduce (9.9) from (9.8). With the notations of (1.9), (9.8) means that

$$H_c^*(X(w), \mathcal{F}_\theta) \xrightarrow{\sim} H^*(X(w), \mathcal{F}_\theta). \quad (9.9.1)$$

If $X(w)$ is affine, then $H^i(X(w), \mathcal{F}_\theta) = 0$ for $i > \dim X(w) = l(w)$ ([10, XIV, 3.2]). The sheaf $\mathcal{F}_\theta$ is locally constant, its dual is $\mathcal{F}_{\theta^{-1}}$ and $X(w)$ is smooth and purely of dimension $l(w)$. By Poincaré duality, $H_c^i(X(w), \mathcal{F}_\theta)$ is dual (up to a twist) to $H^{2l(w)-i}(X(w), \mathcal{F}_{\theta^{-1}})$, hence vanishes for $2l(w) - i > l(w)$, i.e., for $i < l(w)$. This proves the corollary.

9.10. We first construct a nice compactification of $X(w)$. Let $w = s_1 \cdots s_n$ be a minimal expression for w . We define $\overline{X}(s_1, \dots, s_n)$ to be the space of sequences $(B_0, \dots, B_n)$ of Borel subgroups of G , with $B_n = FB_0$ and with B_{i-1} and B_i in relative position s_i or e . It is the inverse image of the graph of Frobenius by the map

$$\alpha : (B_0, \dots, B_n) \mapsto (B_0, B_n) : \overline{O}(s_1, \dots, s_n) \longrightarrow X \times X.$$

In other words, if $\Gamma \xrightarrow{i} X \times X$ is the inclusion in $X \times X$ of the graph of Frobenius, it is the fibre product $\overline{O} \times_{X \times X} \Gamma$:

$$\begin{array}{ccc} \overline{X}(s_1, \dots, s_n) & \longrightarrow & \Gamma \\ \downarrow & & \downarrow i \\ \overline{O}(s_1, \dots, s_n) & \longrightarrow & X \times X. \end{array}$$

LEMMA 9.11. Γ is transverse to $\overline{O}(s, \dots, s)$, as well as to any intersection of the divisors $\overline{D}_i$. The fibre product $\overline{X}(s, \dots, s_n)$ is hence a smooth compactification of $X(w)$, with a divisor with normal crossings (sum of the traces $\overline{D}_i$ of the D_i at infinity).

We will show that Γ is transverse to any smooth G -equivariant scheme $\pi : Y \rightarrow X \times X$ over $X \times X$ (with G acting diagonally on $X \times X$); that is, if $\pi(y) \in \Gamma$, the sum of the tangent space to Γ at $\pi(y)$ and of the image of $d\pi$ is the whole tangent space of $X \times X$ at $\pi(y)$. Indeed

(a) the tangent space of Γ at $\pi(y)$ is $T_x \times \{0\}$;

(b) the image of $d\pi$ contains the image of $\text{Lie}(G)$ by the derivative at $e \in G$ of $g \mapsto g\pi y$ (by the equivariance of Y). Since the space X is homogeneous with reduced stabilizers this image projects onto T_x by the second projection.

9.12. We now investigate how the covering $\tilde{X}(w)$ (with structural group $T(w)^F$) ramifies along the divisor $\overline{D}_i$. The structural group being of order prime to p , the ramification is tame. On each connected component of $\overline{D}_i$, it gives rise to a homomorphism $\tau_i : \hat{\mathbb{Z}}(1) \rightarrow T(w)^F$.

Let $x(t) \in \overline{X}(s_1, \dots, s_n)$ be a one parameter family with $x(0)$ a point of $\overline{D}_i$ (not on any $\overline{D}_j$, $j \neq i$), and with the tangent vector $\dot{x}(0)$ transverse to $\overline{D}_i$. In technical terms: for $S = \text{spectrum of the Henselization of } k[t] \text{ at } (t)$, x is a morphism $x : S \rightarrow \overline{X}(s_1, \dots, s_n)$ such that the closed point $t = 0$ is mapped to a point of $\overline{D}_i$ not on any $\overline{D}_j$, $j \neq i$, and that the inverse image of $\overline{D}_i$ is the reduced scheme $t = 0$. Put $x(t) = (B_0(t), \dots, B_n(t))$ and let E_i be the pull back by $t \mapsto B_i(t)$ of the T -torsor E on X (1.7). If we factor w as in 9.5, the isomorphism $\Psi(w) : E_0 \rightarrow E_n$ (over the generic point of S) factors as

$$\Psi(w) = \Psi(w'_i) \Psi(\dot{s}_i) \Psi(w_{i-1})$$

and $\Psi(w_{i-1})$ and $\Psi(w'_i)$ extend over S ; $\Psi(\dot{s}_i)$ doesn't; rather, the composite $x \mapsto \Psi(\dot{s}_i)(xH_{-\alpha}(t))$ does (9.5), hence $\Psi(w)$ is of the form

$$\Psi(w)(x) = \Psi_0(xH_{w_{i-1}(\alpha_i)}(t))$$

where $\Psi_0 : E_0 \rightarrow E_n$ extends over S . The pull back under x of the $T(w)^F$ -torsor $\tilde{X}(w)$, to the generic point of S , is given by the equation

$$F(u) = \Psi_0(uH_{w_{i-1}(\alpha_i)}(t)). \quad (9.12.1)$$

Let u_0 be a solution, over S , of the equation

$$F(u_0) = \Psi_0(u_0)$$

(this exists, because S is strictly Henselian and F and Ψ_0 extend over S); if we put $u = u_0 y$, (9.12.1) becomes

$$y^{-1} \operatorname{ad} w F(y) = H_{w_{-1}(\alpha_i)}(t). \quad (9.12.2)$$

In other words:

LEMMA 9.13. The $T(w)^F$ -torsor $\tilde{X}(w)$ ramifies along $\overline{D}_i$ in the same way as the pull back under $H_{w_{-1}(\alpha_i)} : G_m \rightarrow T$ of the Lang covering of $T(w)$ ramifies at 0.

The tame fundamental group of G_m is $\widehat{\mathbb{Z}}_{p'}(1)$, that of T is $Y_{p'}^\wedge(1)$ (for Y the dual of the character group of T) and $H_{w_{-1}(\alpha_i)}$ induces $x \mapsto x H_{w_{-1}(\alpha_i)}$:

$$\widehat{\mathbb{Z}}_{p'}(1) \longrightarrow Y_{p'}^\wedge(1).$$

The Lang covering of $T(w)^F$ gives rise to the map $Y_{p'}^\wedge(1) \rightarrow T(w)^F$ described in (5.2). Hence the pull back (9.13) corresponds to the composite

$$\widehat{\mathbb{Z}}_{p'}(1) \xrightarrow{H_{w_{-1}(\alpha_i)}} Y_{p'}^\wedge(1) \longrightarrow T(w)^F.$$

For θ a character of $T(w)^F$, $\mathcal{F}_\theta$ will ramify along $\overline{D}_i$ if and only if θ is not trivial on $H_{w_{-1}(\alpha_i)} \widehat{\mathbb{Z}}_{p'}(1)$. In that case, all higher direct images $R^i j_* \mathcal{F}_\theta$ of $\mathcal{F}_\theta$ ($i \geq 0$) under $j : X(w) \rightarrow \overline{X}(s_1, \dots, s_n)$ will vanish on $\overline{D}_i$. In particular, we have

LEMMA 9.14. If θ is non-singular, $j_* \mathcal{F}_\theta = j_! \mathcal{F}_\theta$ (extension by zero) and $R^i j_* \mathcal{F}_\theta = 0$ for $i > 0$.

Proof of 9.8 (in the guise 9.9.1). By (9.14), the Leray spectral sequence for j reads

$$H^*(\overline{X}(s_1, \dots, s_n), j_! \mathcal{F}_\theta) \xrightarrow{\sim} H^*(X(w), \mathcal{F}_\theta).$$

The space $\overline{X}(s_1, \dots, s_n)$ being a compactification of $X(w)$, the left hand side is by definition $H_c^*(X(w), \mathcal{F}_\theta)$.

Remark 9.15.1. By using arguments parallel to those of (1.6), one can show that the conclusion of (9.9): “for θ non-singular, $H_c^i(\tilde{X}(w), \overline{\mathbb{Q}}_l)_\theta = 0$ for $i \neq l(w)$ ” holds true as soon as there is w' in the F -conjugacy class of w such that $X(w')$ is affine. The criterion (9.7) can be used to check that this is always the case for the classical groups and for G_2 except the case ($G_2, q = 2, w = \text{Coxeter}$) for which a different method applies.

Remark 9.15.2. Let (T', θ') be maximally split (5.17); under an isomorphism $T(w) \xrightarrow{\sim} T'$ (inducing $T(w)^F \xrightarrow{\sim} T'^F$), as in (1.18), θ' becomes a character θ of $T(w)^F$. Proposition 5.24 and the proof of the Induction Theorem

8.2 show that the conclusion of (9.8) still holds for θ . The same applies to (9.9).

THEOREM 9.16. If $u \in G^F$ is a regular unipotent element, then, for any F -stable maximal torus T , we have $Q_{T,G}(u) = 1$.

We must prove that for any $w \in W$, $\text{Tr}(u, H_c^*(X(w))) = 1$. We know that $\text{Tr}(u, H_c^*(X(w)))$ is an integer, and that

$$\sum_{w \in W} \text{Tr}(u, H_c^*(X(w))) = |W|$$

(see (7.14) and its proof). Hence it suffices to prove the

LEMMA 9.17. Under the assumptions of (9.16), $\text{Tr}(u, H_c^*(X(w))) > 0$, for any $w \in W$.

Take $w = s_1 \cdots s_n$ as in (9.10) and let $\bar{X}(s_1, \dots, s_n)$ be the corresponding compactification of $X(w)$. For $P \subset [1, n]$ we write $\bar{D}_P$ for the intersection, in $\bar{X}(s_1, \dots, s_n)$, of the divisors $\bar{D}_i$ ($i \in P$) (9.11). For $P = \emptyset$, $\bar{D}_P$ is $\bar{X}(s_1, \dots, s_n)$. The additivity property of cohomology with compact support shows that

$$\text{Tr}(u, H_c^*(X(w))) = \sum_{P \subset [1, n]} (-1)^{|P|} \text{Tr}(u, H^*(\bar{D}_P)). \quad (9.17.1)$$

Let b be the unique fixed point of u in X . Then $a = (b, \dots, b)$ is the unique fixed point of u in $\bar{X}(s_1, \dots, s_n)$; it is contained in each $\bar{D}_P$. The variety $\bar{D}_P$ being smooth and compact, $\text{Tr}(u, H^*(\bar{D}_P))$ is just the multiplicity of the unique fixed point a of u acting on $\bar{D}_P$; to compute it, we may replace $\bar{D}_P$ by its completion $\hat{D}_P$ at a . Let (x_i) be a formal coordinate system for $\bar{X}(s_1, \dots, s_n)$ at a , such that $x_i = 0$ is an equation for $\hat{D}_i$. In terms of these coordinates, u maps the point with coordinates $x_1, \dots, x_n$ into the point with coordinates $P_1(x_1, \dots, x_n), \dots, P_n(x_1, \dots, x_n)$, for some formal power series P_i . Since the divisor $\hat{D}_i$ is preserved by u , P_i is divisible by x_i . The jacobian matrix of u at $(0, \dots, 0)$ is hence diagonal; u being of order a power of p , it is the identity, and we have

$$P_i = x_i(1 + Q_i).$$

with $Q_i(0, \dots, 0) = 0$. The fixed point scheme of u is given by the equations $x_i Q_i = 0$.

Let E_i be the divisor $Q_i = 0$. It is non-empty. The formula (9.17.1) can be rewritten

$$\begin{aligned} \text{Tr}(u, H_c^*(X(w))) &= \sum_{P \subset [1, n]} (-1)^{|P|} \prod_{i \in P} \hat{D}_i \prod_{j \notin P} (\hat{D}_j + E_j) \\ &= \sum_{P \subset Q \subset [1, n]} (-1)^{|P|} \prod_{i \in Q} \hat{D}_i \prod_{j \notin Q} E_j \\ &= \sum_{Q \subset [1, n]} \left(\sum_{P \subset Q} (-1)^{|P|} \right) \prod_{i \in Q} \hat{D}_i \prod_{j \notin Q} E_j \\ &= \prod_j E_j > 0, \end{aligned}$$

(the product of n divisors stands for the multiplicity of their intersection).

PROPOSITION 9.18. Let $s \in G^F$ be a semisimple element. Let ν be the class function on G^F defined by:

$$\nu(g) = \begin{cases} |Z^0 Z^0(s)^F| q^{l(Z^0(s))} \frac{|Z(s)^F|}{|Z^0(s)^F|}, & \text{if } g \in G^F \text{ is regular with semisimple} \\ & \text{part conjugate in } G^F \text{ to } s, \\ 0, & \text{otherwise.} \end{cases}$$

Then ν is the character of

$$\frac{1}{|Z^0(s)^F|} \sum_{s \in T} |T^F| \sum_{\theta \in (T^F)^-} \theta(s)^{-1} R_T^\theta.$$

(Here $Z^0 Z^0(s)$ is the connected centre of the connected centralizer of s , and $l(Z^0(s))$ is the semisimple rank of $Z^0(s)$.) The proof is similar to that of (7.5); it uses (9.16) and (4.2) instead of (7.2).

For any $\rho \in \mathcal{R}(G^F)$ we have

$$\langle \rho, \nu \rangle = \frac{|Z^0 Z^0(s)^F|}{|Z^0(s)^F|} q^{l(Z^0(s))} \sum_{u \in A(s)} \rho(su) \quad (9.18.1)$$

where $A(s)$ is the set of regular unipotent elements in $Z^0(s)^F$.

COROLLARY 9.19. For any $\rho \in \mathcal{R}(G^F)$, the average value of the character of ρ on the regular elements in G^F with semisimple part s , equals

$$\frac{1}{|A(s)|} \sum_{u \in A(s)} \text{Tr}(su, \rho) = \frac{1}{|Z^0(s)^F|} \sum_{s \in T} |T^F| \sum_{\theta \in (T^F)^-} \theta(s) \langle \rho, R_T^\theta \rangle.$$

This follows from (9.18), (9.18.1) and the following lemma.

LEMMA 9.20. The number of regular unipotent elements in G^F equals

$$|G^F|/|Z^0(s)^F| q^l.$$

(Here Z^0 is the connected centre of G and l is the semisimple rank of G .)

To count regular unipotents in G^F , we observe that any such element is contained in a unique Borel subgroup and then count the regular unipotents in G^F contained in a fixed F -stable Borel subgroup.

10. A decomposition of the Gelfand-Graev representation

10.1. Let $(G^F)^\sim$ be the set of isomorphism classes of irreducible representations of G^F (over $\overline{\mathbb{Q}}_l$). For any $\rho \in (G^F)^\sim$, there exists an F -stable maximal torus T and $\theta \in (T^F)^\sim$ such that $\langle \rho, R_T^\theta \rangle \neq 0$ (7.7); moreover the geometric conjugacy class $[\theta]$ of (T, θ) (see 5.5), is uniquely determined by ρ (6.3). We thus get a well-defined surjective map

$$(G^F)^\sim \longrightarrow \mathfrak{C} \quad (10.1.1)$$

where $\mathfrak{S}$ is the set of all geometric conjugacy classes of pairs (T, θ) .

10.2. In the rest of this chapter we shall assume that the centre Z of G is connected. Let T^*, B^* be as in (1.8). Let U^* be the unipotent radical of B^* and let $U_\bullet^*$ be the subgroup of U^* generated by the root subgroups corresponding to non-simple roots. The quotient $U^*/U_\bullet^*$ is commutative and is a direct product over the simple roots α : $\prod_\alpha U_\alpha^*$, with U_α^* one-dimensional. Let I be the set of orbits of F on the simple roots. For any $i \in I$, let $U_i^* = \prod_{\alpha \in i} U_\alpha^*$; then $U^*/U_\bullet^* = \prod_{i \in I} U_i^*$. This decomposition is F -stable, hence we have also $U^{*F}/U_{\bullet}^{*F} = \prod_{i \in I} U_i^{*F}$.

We consider the Gelfand-Graev representation $\Gamma_G = \text{Ind}_{U^{*F}}^{G^F}(\chi)$ where χ is any character of U^{*F} which is trivial on $U_{\bullet}^{*F}$ and defines a non-trivial character of U_i^{*F} for all $i \in I$. All such χ are conjugate under T^{*F} , since Z is connected, hence the G^F -module Γ_G is well-defined up to isomorphism.

Let Δ_G be the class function on G^F which equals $|Z^F|q^l$ on any regular unipotent element in G^F and vanishes on all other elements. (l is the semisimple rank of G .) The following result shows that this is the character of a virtual representation of G^F (which will be also denoted by Δ_G):

PROPOSITION 10.3. For any subset $J \subset I$, let $P(J) \supset B^*$ be the parabolic subgroup generated by B^* and by the root subgroups corresponding to minus the simple roots in F -orbits in J . Let $L(J)$ be $P(J)$ modulo its unipotent radical. Then

$$\Delta_G = \sum_{J \subset I} (-1)^{|J|} \text{Ind}_{P(J)^F}^{G^F}(\Gamma_{L(J)}). \quad (10.3.1)$$

(Note that the centre of $L(J)$ is connected, since that of G is, hence $\Gamma_{L(J)}$ is well-defined.)

Remark 10.4. The following identity is a formal consequence of (10.3.1):

$$\Gamma_G = \sum_{J \subset I} (-1)^{|J|} \text{Ind}_{P(J)^F}^{G^F}(\Delta_{L(J)}).$$

10.5. Proof of 10.3. For any subset $J \subset I$, let $\mathcal{C}(J)$ be the set of characters χ of U^{*F} with $\chi|_{U_{\bullet}^{*F}} = 1$ and such that χ induces a non-trivial character of U_i^{*F} ($i \in I$) if and only if $i \in J$. It is easy to see that, for any $\chi \in \mathcal{C}(J)$, we have

$$\text{Ind}_{P(J)^F}^{G^F}(\Gamma_{L(J)}) = \text{Ind}_{U^{*F}}^{G^F}(\chi).$$

Let $u_0 \in U^{*F}$ be a fixed regular unipotent element; in other words, the image of u_0 in U_i^{*F} is non-zero for any $i \in I$. It follows that

$$\sum_{\chi \in \mathcal{C}(J)} \chi(u_0) = (-1)^{|J|}.$$

Hence (10.3.1) is equivalent to:

$$\Delta_G = \sum_{\chi \in \mathcal{C}} \chi(u_0) \text{Ind}_{U^{*F}}^{G^F}(\chi) \quad (10.5.1)$$

where $\mathcal{C} = \bigcup_{J \in I} \mathcal{C}(J)$. The character of the right hand side of (10.5.1) vanishes at non-unipotent elements. Its value at $u \in U^{*F}$ is:

$$\begin{aligned} & |U^{*F}|^{-1} \sum_{\substack{g \in G^F \\ g^{-1}ug \in U^{*F}}} \sum_{\chi \in \mathcal{C}} \chi(g^{-1}ug u_0) \\ &= q^l |U^{*F}|^{-1} \#\{g \in G^F \mid g^{-1}ug \in U^{*F}, g^{-1}ug u_0 \in U^{*F}\}. \end{aligned} \quad (10.5.2)$$

This is zero unless $u \in U^{*F}$ is regular unipotent; we now assume that $u \in U^{*F}$ is regular unipotent. For any $g \in G^F$ with $g^{-1}ug \in U^{*F}$, we have $u \in B^* \cap gB^*g^{-1}$; but B^* is the only Borel subgroup containing u , hence $g \in B^{*F}$. If $g = tu'$, $t \in T^{*F}$, $u' \in U^{*F}$, the relation $g^{-1}ug u_0 \in U^{*F}$ determines t uniquely modulo Z^F and leaves u' arbitrary. Thus the expression (10.5.2) becomes

$$q^l |U^{*F}|^{-1} |Z^F| |U^{*F}| = |Z^F| q^l,$$

and (10.3) is proved.

We shall now prove the following

LEMMA 10.6. Let M be a virtual representation of G^F such that

$$\langle M, M \rangle = |Z^F| q^l \quad \text{and} \quad \langle M, R_T^\theta \rangle = \varepsilon_T^\theta = \pm 1$$

for any F -stable maximal torus $T \subset G$ and any $\theta \in T^{\vee F}$. Then

$$M = \sum_{x \in \mathfrak{S}} \sigma_x M_x$$

where $\sigma_x = \pm 1$ and M_x are distinct irreducible representations of G^F such that

$$M_x = \sigma_x \sum_{\substack{(T, \theta) \bmod G^F \\ [\theta] = x}} \frac{\varepsilon_T^\theta}{\langle R_T^\theta, R_T^\theta \rangle} R_T^\theta.$$

Let $\{M\}$ be the set of all $\rho \in (G^F)^\sim$ such that $\langle \rho, M \rangle \neq 0$; $\{M\}$ has at most $|Z^F| q^l$ elements. By our assumption and by 5.7(i), the map $\{M\} \rightarrow \mathfrak{S}$ (the restriction of (10.1.1)) is surjective. Since $|\mathfrak{S}| = |Z^F| q^l$ (5.7), it is bijective and $\{M\}$ has exactly $|Z^F| q^l$ elements. Let $M_x \in \{M\}$ be the element corresponding to $x \in \mathfrak{S}$ under this bijection; we must have $M = \sum_{x \in \mathfrak{S}} \sigma_x M_x$, $\sigma_x = \pm 1$, since $\langle M, M \rangle = |\{M\}|$. If (T, θ) is such that $[\theta] = x$, we have

$$\langle M, R_T^\theta \rangle = \sigma_x \langle M_x, R_T^\theta \rangle = \varepsilon_T^\theta;$$

from the orthogonality of the R_T^θ 's (6.8) we have

$$M_x = \sigma_x \sum_{\substack{(T, \theta) \bmod G^F \\ [\theta] = x}} \frac{\varepsilon_T^\theta}{\langle R_T^\theta, R_T^\theta \rangle} R_T^\theta + M'_x$$

where M'_x is orthogonal to all the R_T^θ 's. It remains to prove that $M'_x = 0$. Since M_x is irreducible, this would follow if we prove that $\langle M_x - M'_x, M_x - M'_x \rangle = 1$; we certainly have $\langle M_x - M'_x, M_x - M'_x \rangle \leq 1$, hence it is sufficient to prove

that

$$\sum_{x \in \mathfrak{S}} \langle M_x - M'_x, M_x - M'_x \rangle = |Z^F| q^l$$

or, in other words, that

$$\sum_{(T, \theta) \bmod G^F} \frac{1}{\langle R_T^\theta, R_T^\theta \rangle} = |Z^F| q^l.$$

By (6.8), this is equivalent to the identity

$$\sum_{T \bmod G^F} \frac{1}{|W(T)^F|} |T^F| = |Z^F| q^l,$$

which is the same as

$$\frac{1}{|\mathbf{W}|} \sum_{w \in \mathbf{W}} \det(q - w\tau) = q^l$$

where w is regarded as an automorphism of the lattice $X_0 = X(T/Z)$ and τ is defined by $F^* = q \cdot \tau^{-1}$. The last identity (compare Steinberg [15, p. 91]) can be written as

$$\sum_{0 \leq i \leq l} (-1)^i q^{l-i} \frac{1}{|\mathbf{W}|} \sum_{w \in \mathbf{W}} \text{Tr}(w\tau, \Lambda^i(X_0)) = q^l$$

and follows from the fact that $\Lambda^i(X_0)^{\mathbf{W}} = 0$ for $i > 0$ (5.8).

THEOREM 10.7. We recall that Z is connected. Let $x \in \mathfrak{S}$, and x' be a representative of the corresponding semisimple conjugacy class in the dual group (5.24). We define δ_x to be the $\mathbb{F}_q$ -rank of the centralizer of x' .

(i) The formulae

$$\rho_x = \sum_{\substack{(T, \theta) \bmod G^F \\ [\theta] = x}} \frac{(-1)^{\sigma(G) - \sigma(T)}}{\langle R_T^\theta, R_T^\theta \rangle} R_T^\theta \quad (10.7.1)$$

and

$$\rho'_x = (-1)^{\sigma(G) - \delta_x} \sum_{\substack{(T, \theta) \bmod G^F \\ [\theta] = x}} \frac{1}{\langle R_T^\theta, R_T^\theta \rangle} R_T^\theta \quad (10.7.2)$$

define irreducible representations of G^F . The $|Z^F| q^l$ elements $\rho_x \in (G^F)^\sim$, $x \in \mathfrak{S}$ (resp. $\rho'_x \in (G^F)^\sim$, $x \in \mathfrak{S}$) are distinct. The maps $x \mapsto \rho_x$, $x \mapsto \rho'_x$ are two cross-sections of the map (10.1.1).

(ii) One has

$$\Gamma_G = \sum_{x \in \mathfrak{S}} \rho_x = \sum_{(T, \theta) \bmod G^F} \frac{(-1)^{\sigma(G) - \sigma(T)}}{\langle R_T^\theta, R_T^\theta \rangle} R_T^\theta, \quad (10.7.3)$$

$$\Delta_G = \sum_{x \in \mathfrak{S}} (-1)^{\sigma(G) - \delta_x} \rho'_x = \sum_{(T, \theta) \bmod G^F} \frac{1}{\langle R_T^\theta, R_T^\theta \rangle} R_T^\theta. \quad (10.7.4)$$

(iii) Assume that all the roots have the same length. Fix (T, θ) in the geometric conjugacy class x , let S be the connected centralizer of (T, θ) (5.19) and let θ_S be the corresponding character of S^F . We have

$$\rho_x \otimes \text{St}_G = \text{Ind}_{S^F}^{G^F} (\theta_S \otimes \text{St}_S \otimes \text{St}_S) \quad (10.7.5)$$

$$\rho'_x \otimes \text{St}_G = \text{Ind}_{S^F}^{G^F} (\theta_S \otimes \text{St}_S). \quad (10.7.6)$$

(iv) Let S^* be the centralizer of x' . We still have

$$\dim \rho_x = \frac{|G^F|/|\text{St}_G(e)|}{|S^{*F}|/|\text{St}_{S^*}(e)|} \cdot \text{St}_{S^*}(e), \quad (10.7.7)$$

$$\dim \rho'_x = \frac{|G^F|/|\text{St}_G(e)|}{|S^{*F}|/|\text{St}_{S^*}(e)|}. \quad (10.7.8)$$

If we tensor the right hand side of (10.7.1) by St_G we find (by 7.3):

$$\sum_{\substack{(T, \theta) \bmod G^F \\ [\theta] = x}} \frac{1}{\langle R_T^\theta, R_T^\theta \rangle} \text{Ind}_{T^F}^{G^F}(\theta). \quad (10.7.9)$$

Let us first assume that all roots have the same length. By 5.14(ii), the G^F -conjugacy classes of pairs (T, θ) , $T \subset G$, with $[\theta] = x$ are in one-to-one correspondence with S^F -conjugacy classes of pairs $(T', \theta_S|_{T'})$, with T' an F -stable maximal torus in S . Moreover, by 5.14(i) and (6.8), we have $\langle R_T^\theta, R_T^\theta \rangle = |W_S(T')^F|$. Thus the expression (10.7.9) equals

$$\begin{aligned} & \sum_{\substack{T' \subset S \\ \bmod S^F}} \frac{1}{|W_S(T')^F|} \text{Ind}_{T'^F}^{G^F}(\theta_S|_{T'}) \\ &= \sum_{\substack{T' \subset S \\ \bmod S^F}} \frac{1}{|W_S(T')^F|} \text{Ind}_{S^F}^{G^F}(\text{Ind}_{T'^F}^{S^F}(1) \otimes \theta_S) \\ &= \text{Ind}_{S^F}^{G^F} \left(\sum_{\substack{T' \subset S \\ \bmod S^F}} \frac{1}{|W_S(T')^F|} \text{Ind}_{T'^F}^{S^F}(1) \otimes \theta_S \right) \\ &= \text{Ind}_{S^F}^{G^F}(\theta_S \otimes \text{St}_S \otimes \text{St}_S), \quad \text{by 7.14.} \end{aligned}$$

Similarly, by tensoring the right hand side of (10.7.2) by St_G , we find

$$\text{Ind}_{S^F}^{G^F} \left(\sum_{\substack{T' \subset S \\ \bmod S^F}} \frac{(-1)^{\sigma(S) - \sigma(T')}}{|W_S(T')^F|} \text{Ind}_{T'^F}^{S^F}(1) \otimes \theta_S \right) = \text{Ind}_{S^F}^{G^F}(\theta_S \otimes \text{St}_S), \quad \text{by 7.14.}$$

In general, the G^F -conjugacy classes of pairs (T, θ) , with $[\theta] = x$, are in one-to-one correspondence with the G^{*F} -conjugacy classes of pairs (T', θ') , with θ' conjugate to x' (5.24), i.e., with the S^{*F} -conjugacy classes of pairs $(T', x'), (T' \subset S^*)$. The dimension of (10.7.9) is that of

$$\sum_{T' \subset S^*} \frac{1}{|W_{S^*}(T')^F|} \text{Ind}_{T'^F}^{G^{*F}}(1)$$

(because $|G^{*F}| = |G^F|$), while that of (10.7.2) $\otimes \text{St}_G$ is

$$\sum_{T' \subset S^*} \frac{(-1)^{\sigma(S) - \sigma(T')}}{|W_{S^*}(T')^F|} \text{Ind}_{T'^F}^{G^F}(1)$$

and the same proof as above gives (10.7.7), (10.7.8).

We now show that (10.6) can be applied with $M = \Gamma_G$ or Δ_G . We have

$$\begin{aligned} \langle \Delta_G, \Delta_G \rangle &= \frac{1}{|G^F|} (|Z^F|q^l)^2 \#\{\text{regular unipotents in } G^F\} \\ &= \frac{1}{|G^F|} (|Z^F|q^l)^2 \frac{|G^F|}{|Z^F|q^l} = |Z^F|q^l \quad (\text{by 9.20}). \end{aligned}$$

The analogous identity $\langle \Gamma_G, \Gamma_G \rangle = |Z^F|q^l$ follows from R. Steinberg ([14]). Now, for any (T, θ) , $\langle \Delta_G, R_T^\theta \rangle$ equals the average value of the character of R_T^θ on the regular unipotents in G^F hence equals 1, by (9.16).

We now prove that $\langle \Gamma_G, R_T^\theta \rangle = (-1)^{\sigma(G) - \sigma(T)}$ for any (T, θ) . Using a result of Rodier (cf. T. A. Springer, *Caractères de groupes de Chevalley finis*, Sémin. Bourbaki 429, Fév. 1973) and the induction formula 8.2, we are reduced to the case where T is not contained in any proper F -stable parabolic subgroup of G . Using (10.3.1) and the already known fact that $\langle \Delta_G, R_T^\theta \rangle = 1$, we see that it is enough to prove

$$\langle \text{Ind}_{P(J)^F}^{G^F}(\Gamma_{L(J)}), R_T^\theta \rangle = 0, \quad J \neq I. \quad (10.7.8)$$

(Note that in this case $(-1)^{\sigma(G) - \sigma(T)} = (-1)^{|I|}$.) Assuming that the theorem is already proved for groups of dimension strictly smaller than that of G and, in particular, for $L(J)$, we see from (10.7.5) and (8.2) that $\text{Ind}_{P(J)^F}^{G^F}(\Gamma_{L(J)})$ is a linear combination of terms of the form $R_{T'}^{\theta'}$, with $T' \subset P(J)$, $FT' = T'$, so that (10.7.8) follows from the orthogonality formula (6.8).

Now (10.7.1), (10.7.2), (10.7.5), (10.7.6) follow directly from (10.6) applied to $M = \Gamma_G$ or Δ_G , except for an indeterminacy of sign. To remove this indeterminacy of sign, we only have to check that the right hand sides of (10.7.1) and (10.7.2) have strictly positive dimension; but they are both of the form $|G^F|/|S^{*F}|$ up to a power of q , by the first part of the proof. The theorem is proved.

COROLLARY 10.8. For any $\rho \in (G^F)^\sim$, the average value of the character of ρ on the regular unipotents in G^F equals 0, 1, or -1 . This value is ± 1 if and only if $\rho = \rho'_x$ for some $x \in \mathfrak{S}$.

Indeed, this average value is just $\langle \rho, \Delta_G \rangle$.

Remark 10.9. If we assume that p is a good prime for G , then all regular unipotents in G^F fall in a single G^F -conjugacy class so that the character of ρ at any regular unipotent in G^F equals 0, 1, or -1 . This was first proved in the article by J. A. Green, G. I. Lehrer, and G. Lusztig (On the degrees of certain group characters, to appear in *The Quarterly Journal of Mathematics*).

PROPOSITION 10.10. Let $x \in \mathfrak{S}$. Let (T, θ) be a maximally split pair in x

(see (5.17); (T, θ) is uniquely defined up to G^F -conjugacy by (5.18)). Then the virtual representation $(-1)^{\sigma(G)-\sigma(T)} R_T^\theta$ of G^F can be represented by an actual G^F -module, in which ρ_x and ρ'_x occur with multiplicity 1.

By (5.23), there exists an F -stable parabolic subgroup $P \subset G$ such that T is contained in some F -stable Levi subgroup L of P and (T, θ) is non-singular in L . L has connected centre, hence, by 5.20, (T, θ) is non-degenerate in L . Let $R_{T,L}^\theta$ be the virtual representation corresponding to (T, θ) with respect to L (see 1.20). By 7.4,

$$(-1)^{\sigma(L)-\sigma(T)} R_{T,L}^\theta = (-1)^{\sigma(G)-\sigma(T)} R_{T,L}^\theta$$

is irreducible. By 8.2,

$$(-1)^{\sigma(G)-\sigma(T)} R_T^\theta = \text{Ind}_{P^F}^{G^F} ((-1)^{\sigma(G)-\sigma(T)} R_{T,L}^\theta),$$

hence it can be realized as an actual G^F -module.

It remains to observe that for any (T, θ) in x (not necessarily maximally split) we have (by (10.7.1), (10.7.2), and (6.8)):

$$\langle \rho_x, R_T^\theta \rangle = (-1)^{\sigma(G)-\sigma(T)},$$

$$\langle \rho'_x, R_T^\theta \rangle = (-1)^{\sigma(G)-\delta_x}.$$

11. Suzuki and Ree groups

Our methods apply also to the Suzuki and Ree groups ${}^2B_2(q)$, ${}^2G_2(q)$, ${}^2F_4(q)$ (with q an odd power of $\sqrt{2}$, resp. $\sqrt{3}$, $\sqrt{2}$).

These groups are the fixed point set of an exceptional isogeny $F' : G \rightarrow G$, with G respectively of type B_2 , G_2 and F_4 , and F'^2 being the Frobenius endomorphism relative to a rational structure over the field with q^2 elements (R. Steinberg [15]). For the sake of induction, one should more generally consider groups of the form $G^{F'}$, with G reductive and F'^2 the Frobenius endomorphism relative to a rational structure over $\mathbb{F}_{q^2}$ (q an odd power of $\sqrt{2}$ or $\sqrt{3}$). Besides the Suzuki and Ree groups, this includes for instance groups of the form $G = G_1 \times G_1$, with $F'(x, y) = (Fy, x)$; for such a group, $G^{F'} = G_1^F$.

All definitions and results in Chapter 1 can be given with F replaced by F' throughout; in particular, for any F' -stable maximal torus T in G and any Borel subgroup B containing T , the subscheme $X_{T \subset B}$ of X_G and the $G^{F'}$ -equivariant $T^{F'}$ -torsor $\tilde{X}_{T \subset B}$ over $X_{T \subset B}$ are well-defined (1.17). Thus for any $\theta \in (T^{F'})^\sim$, the virtual representation $R_{T \subset B}^\theta$ of $G^{F'}$ is well-defined (1.20). For $G = G_1 \times G_1$, $F'(x, y) = (Fy, x)$, this coincides with the similar representation of $G_1^F = G^{F'}$.

All the results in Chapters 4, 5, 9 (except (9.18), (9.19)), the disjointness

Theorem 6.2 (with its Corollary 6.3), the results (7.13) and (8.2) continue to be true. On the other hand, the proofs of the orthogonality relations (6.8), (6.9), and of the dimension formula (7.1) require the assumption $|T^{F'}| > 1$. If $q > 2$ this is automatically satisfied: $|T^{F'}|$ is of the form $\prod (q - \rho_i)$, where $|\rho_i| = 1$, hence $|T^{F'}| > \prod (q - 1)$. Thus, if we exclude the case where q equals $\sqrt{2}$ or $\sqrt{3}$, all the results in Chapters 6, 7, 8, 10 hold, as well as (9.18), (9.19). They can all be deduced from the orthogonality relations (6.8), (6.9). Even in the case $q = \sqrt{2}$ or $\sqrt{3}$, we can prove them for 2B_2 and 2G_2 , but we cannot handle ${}^2F_4(\sqrt{2})$.

ADDED IN PROOF (2nd Dec. 1975). We can now handle ${}^2F_4(\sqrt{2})$, too; this will be considered by one of us, in a future article.

INSTITUT DES HAUTES ÉTUDES SCIENTIFIQUES, FRANCE

MATHEMATICS INSTITUTE, UNIVERSITY OF WARWICK, ENGLAND

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(Received June 6, 1975)